accidents happen (even if this maybe wasn't one...)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31098470.

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Catra/Lonnie (She-Ra)

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catradora, Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Past Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Oblivious Adora (She-Ra), Jealous Adora (She-Ra), adora doesn't know shes gay, catra knows shes gay, my guess at what happened before shera started, in this theyre all above 18 (even if it doesn't match timelines, Angst, Fluff, Mutual Pining, Bittersweet Ending, ends at the start of show

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by abutterflyonthewind

Summary

to put it simply:

adora walks in on catra and lonnie and tries to figure out why she feels so strange.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

adora just wanted to go on a walk

As Adora head down one of the many metallic corridors of the Fright Zone, something made her stop in her tracks.

“God look at you. Totally helpless…”

That voice…was that... Lonnie? Who was she talking to? And why was she in the changing rooms, training had ended hours ago and it was well past shower time.
Creeping closer, Adora pressed her ear up against the cold door, intent on figuring out who else was in there.

She had originally gone out to find Catra on the roof, but after realising she wasn’t in her usual spot, had taken to wandering the halls in search of her.

“...in such a mess for me...”

No matter how much she strained her ears, Adora simply couldn’t pick up on any reply. If she wanted to figure out what was going on, she’d have to get much closer.

A low whimper proceeded from the room, making the hair on Adoras arms stand to attention.

Catra?

Oh my god, Catra was in there with Lonnie. And she was doing something to her, no doubt in attempts to get back at catra for clawing her arm in training earlier.

“You didn’t think I’d let you off that easily; did you?" A hint of laughter in Lonnies voice.

What was going on in there? And why wasn’t Catra fighting back?

“I swear to god Lonnie if you don’t stop I’ll ...“

Her speech was cut off by a loud moan strung together with a series of curse words.

What in the-?
Oh. Oh no. Realisation crashed over Adora like a tidal wave. Catra and Lonnie were... and Catra she'd just... Lonnie had made Catra...
Surely not. They hated each other. No, it must be something else.

Despite her denial this felt wrong. It was as if her heart was beating throughout her entire body. Adora was *not* meant to be witnessing this. And yet… something about that sound Catra had made caused Adora to feel rooted in place.
Before she could stop herself, she cracked the door open ever so slightly, instantly wishing she hadn't for the sight was enough to make her throat close up.

There in front of her was Catra, pinned up against the wall by Lonnie. Her legs wrapped around the other girls' torso, eyes fluttering as she panted with ragged breaths against her neck. Her tail curled around Lonnie's leg, caressing it slightly with the tip, her hands tangled in Lonnies hair.

Adora couldn't breathe.

Lonnie's hand was clasped around Catras neck, ever so slightly rubbing at her jaw. Adora began following the other one down much lower...

Oh god. Oh Jesus, oh god. Lonnie and Catra were literally fucking! What was she doing standing here watching them! What sort of sick person watched people have sex! Especially without them knowing?

She couldn't let them see her, there was no way Adora could ever let them see her.

A tugging sensation erupted in her lower stomach making her suddenly want to charge the room and rip Lonnie off of Catra.

Another long whine filtered through the door.

Everything was spinning. Adora had to leave.
She stumbled away, grasping at the walls for support, trying desperately to navigate her way back to the bunks. No. she needed air. She needed to be outside.

Bursting through to the balcony, she head straight for the ladder leading up to the roof, switching to auto pilot clambering up the steps. Everything was still spinning but breathing in the outside air (despite the smog that clung to it) seemed to be helping.

Flinging herself onto the roof Adora took a moment to catch her breath as the same images of Catra danced through her mind.

The more she thought about it the worse she felt. Picturing the way Catras eyes had rolled back into her head, her legs tightening their grip around Lonnies waist, her short and ragged breaths intertwined with soft whimpers against the girls neck as the other had bit down onto her shoulder.

But worst of all were Lonnies words taunting Adora on repeat:
In such a mess for me
Adora couldn't unsee it.

And then there was the way Adora had felt watching it all. The throbbing that had developed both in her head and in… other places. The way she'd felt enraged at the sight of Lonnie touching Catra in that way, at the way Catra *let* Lonnie touch her in that way…
How she couldn't tear her eyes off of Catras face for a second in fear she might miss something.

Adora didn't understand what was happening to her.
She didn't know why she felt this way. Catra was her friend, her best friend, shouldn't she be happy she has someone that makes her feel like… that.
Even if it was Lonnie?

No, she shouldn't, a small part of her mind whispered, *Catra's yours, not Lonnies.*
Adora desperately tried to stamp out the sound.
The whole thing made her sick. She just had to forget it. Ignore it. Stop thinking about all the things Lonnie and Catra could've done together, could've said to each other, all the sounds Catra could have made with her...

Shutting her eyes tight, Adora begged her mind to stop; willing for peace to wash over her.
She stayed out on the roof until the deep crimson sky turned to stripes of purple and blue; the reddish tinge dulling to no more than a whisper.

The Fright Zone looked almost peaceful at night. Almost.

Adora wasn't sure when she got back to the bunks, only that everyone was already sleeping. Carefully sliding herself under the covers as to not disturb the sleeping girl at the end of the bed, who immediately began purring at the dip, she settled into the covers. Adora urged herself not to look at the girl, not to think about what she'd seen her do…

But no matter how much she tried, the last thing she saw before falling asleep that night was the way Catra would look with Adora pinning her against the wall.

Things didn't get much better afterwards. Every time Catra was missing, so was Lonnie; and each time one of them reappeared shortly followed by the other, Adora felt as if she might throw up. It didn't stop Catra being her usual self, pouncing on Adora, pinning her to the floor. But every time she did, Adora couldn't help but have flashbacks to how she looked that night.

The most confusing times where when Lonnie spoke to Adora. The girls soft aurburn ones were always met with steely blue, but

Adora couldn't figure out why. It was like she was physically unable to be nice to her.

"Adora what's gotten into you lately? Its like you can't even hear me calling for support next to you."
"Well maybe I can hear you. Maybe I just don't want to respond."
She didn't mean to say that aloud…

"Jeez Adora, is it that time of the month for you or something? Because you're being a serious bitch lately"

Adora scoffs, unsure of what she's actually trying to say

"says you Lonnie" she said her name laced with venom.
"Its not just me Adora. We're all thinking it! Right Rogelio? Kyle?"

The boys shuffled a bit, unsure of whether or not to get involved.

Catra broke the silence, stepping towards her slightly as she reached for Adoras hand.
"She's right Adora. You've been acting… strange for a couple days now. Is everything okay?"

"Yes Catra. Everything is fine." She snatched away her hand,
"I'm fine. Why does everything think I'm anything but FINE!"

The last part came out louder than she had intended causing the others to back off a bit, however the slight eye contact exchanged wasn't hidden from her.
Oh good one Adora, now you actually do seem crazy.

After that…disagreement, Adora started to withdraw from the team, even from Catra, throwing herself into training.
Every time asked what was wrong, she would just pass it off as Shadow Weaver telling her she needed to train harder so she was tired.
However, the look in Catras eyes each time told her the girl didn't

believe a word she said, yet upon realising pressing further got her nowhere, she began to stop asking.

Adora knew she felt pushed away but that didn't make her feel any less shocked the first night Catra didn't slip off her bed onto Adora's.

It's not like she *wanted* to push Catra away. She was the only real friend Adora had, only real friend Adora wanted. But something was different now. The longer they spent together one on one, the more Adora felt she might do something she'd regret.

And she couldn't risk that, not here, not now,
Not Ever.

The memories didn't fade either. Each night they'd creep into her dreams, tormenting her until she fell into darkness, the only think to see being Catras face pushed up against the wall, crying out with pleasure.

Roughly three weeks after the incident (as Adora had begun calling it) had occurred, she finally felt like things were going okay.
Sure, her and Catra were on odd terms and the sight of Lonnie even in the same room as her made her feel queasy but still, her extra training (that was definitely not to avoid Catra) seemed to be paying off.
Her marks were never short of 100 and Adora had even overheard Shadow Weaver speaking to one of the older regiment captains about maybe integrating Adora in with their team which was great!

So why did she feel so empty?

It was during one of her late-night training sessions, in which Adora was so into battling one of the ultimate princesses, that she didn't notice the soft plodding of feet enter the room.

Adora was collapsed atop the badly beaten bot, exhausted but feeling accomplished, having beaten it in a new record time.

“Hey Adora…”

“Catra! Hi! I didn’t hear you come in. How long have you been there?”

Awhile was the only reply given.
She could feel Catra staring at her, those luminescent eyes boring straight into her soul.
How was she able to do that?

“Why do you hate me?”

Of all things Adora was prepared for, Catra asking her this was not one of them.

“Catra wha-“

“Don’t deny it.”, She said it like an order;
I’ve seen how you’ve been avoiding me. Doing extra training when we used to sneak out to the roof. Purposely coming back late when everyone’s asleep and then leaving before we wake, well everyone but me but that’s not the point. If it’s something I did please can you just tell me so we can figure it out. Please?”

Catras eyes dropped to the floor scanning over the cracks with great intensity. With her tail dropping between her legs, her ears so far down they practically touched the side of her head, the sight made her chest ache.
Catra looked… scared.

Adora felt taken aback.
Had she done this? Surely Catra hadn’t missed her that much in these last two weeks. I mean, she had Lonnie now… She didn’t need Adora... right?

“Adora don’t ignore me. I can practically see your mind whirring behind your eyes. Tell me what I did wrong so we can go back to

normal, please”

Her eyes looked like moons eclipsed by a black hole as she stared up at Adora from below.

"Did Shadow Weaver… did she… did she say something?
Be...because she can’t control who you like Adora! You can’t... I can’t let her do that to you... to me.”

The last line was said almost as a whisper, only the echo of the room allowing Adora to catch it.

“Catra I...”

What?
Catra wasn’t wrong. Adora had been ignoring her. But not because she hated her… it was because whenever she was with her, she felt something she didn’t understand.

“I’m sorry Catra. I... I don’t know what to say. I’ve just been... I don’t know confused? about a lot of stuff. But I never wanted to hurt you. I promise I never wanted to hurt you.”

Adora couldn’t read the expression of the other girl.
She climbed down the side of the robot until she was standing directly in front of the her. She’d missed this, their closeness.

“I didn’t do anything wrong?”
A crack crept across Catras words.

“Of course not Catra! You could never do anything that would make me hate you. Ever.”

“Even if I joined sides with the evil princesses?”,
a slight smirk playing across her lips.

Adora felt herself lightly cupping Catras face, lifting their eyes to each other.

“Not Even join the evil princesses.”

The girl let out a long sigh, her face relaxing into the sides of Adora's palms as if a weight had been taken off her.

"Okay good. Just the way you'd been acting lately… I felt like you hated me and you know what Shadow Weaver would do if you... y'know... did."

"Catra don't think like that. I'd never ever let Shadow Weaver take you from me. Ever. I promise"

Before she knew what she was doing, Adora lightly kissed the top of Catras forehead, her soft hair brushing against Adora's lips.
The sudden affection made the other girls' ears snap up.
Was Catra... blushing?

No, it must just be the cold. The Fright Zone was always cold.

Besides, Catra liked Lonnie. And obviously Adora didn't like Catra. I mean she liked Catra, but as a best friend. Because they were best friends. But she didn't like like Catra. Of course she didn't, they were just… best friends. In fact, she probably only felt this way because Catra was her best friend. She didn't want Catra to get hurt. Yes, that was all. She wanted to protect Catra. Because they're best friends.

With a little more volume than needed, Adora slung her arm around Catras shoulders, tugging her to the exit.

"C'mon it's late. We should get back to the bunks before one of Shadow Weavers goons find us"

Adoras voice seemed to snap Catra out of thought,

"Hah yeah...Shadow Weavers goons…"
She trailed, plodding along besides Adora.

They didn't say much else on the way back to the bunks, but just before Adora fell asleep that night she felt the familiar thump of the mattress shifting above her and the brush of a tail wrapping itself around her wrist. Adora sighed. She'd missed this.

weightless... that's how she felt...

Chapter Notes

> WARNING - close to the end a panic attack takes place as well as implied suicidal thoughts so please only read if comfortable
>
> Once again I'm so grateful to everyone reading !!! Ily guys <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catras POV

Catra knew.

How could she not, it's not like Adora's been exactly subtle.

"Hey Adora, whatcha doing?"
"Catra! Oh, uh… nothing"
Adora shot her a lopsided grin.

How does she look so good when she does that?

If Catra was being honest with herself, Adoras ability to look good whilst doing, well pretty much anything, was a theory she was yet to disprove.

"Oh, so you're *totally* not planning me a surprise birthday in the locker room and you *definitely* don't have a paper chain trailing out of your jacket?"

She cocked her eyebrow slightly, shaking her head a little at the other girls clear obviousness.

"Catra! How do you always manage to know when I'm trying to surprise you!"

"Just a hunch I guess"

Catra let out a little laugh as she snatched the paper chain away, little cut out hearts all in a row.
How very Adora-ey.

She could still remember when Adora had first saw an older cadet draw one. She'd immediately started drawing them everywhere, in fact Catra was pretty sure there were at least a dozen on their bed frames alone.

"Well? Do I have to keep waiting for my surprise or can we get this over with?"

"Ugh fine, but only because you already know what it is"
The girl grumbled, trailing off into the locker room

So yeah, Catra knew

Just like Catra knew Adora had watched her get railed by Lonnie.

However, that had less to do with Adoras obviousness, and more to do with Catras heightened senses.
The girl practically reeks her scents so strong!

Not that Catra was complaining – it was actually rather comforting. But she'd rather be taken aboard an alien space ship than admit such a thing to Adora.

Catra was the cool one (or so she liked to think), it was Adoras job to do all the mushy stuff.

So yes, Catra knew Adora had been watching her.
And how had it made her feel?

Really. Fucking. Turned. On.

She doubted she'd have come as hard as she did without the knowledge that the girl she actually wanted to be doing this with, was quite literally on the other side of the door.

And it’s not like she never thought about what’d it’d be like… Hell, if Catra was being honest? She’d gotten off to it on more than one occasion.

How Adora would look straddled on top of her, Catras back pressed against the cold floor, her hips grinding into her own as she pinned Catras arms above her head, planting soft kisses along her jaw, murmuring pretty nothings into her ear.

Adora slowly trailing down Catras neck, sucking on her pulse points, leaving a string of bruises in their wake…

That **stupid dumb smirk** she did, teasing up at her from between Catras legs, the warmth of her breath tickling the folds of her clit as she edged closer and closer, but never close enough, just to make her beg…

So yes, one *might* say she’d given the affair some thought.

But anyways, it’s not like Adora would actually do those things to her, it was just a fantasy, albeit a regular one.

Fall in love with the pretty girl, have her be straight.
Fan-fucking-tastic.

It was just one of the many ways the universe used to taunt Catra.

*What are you even on about Catra, you’re not **in love** with her. You just think she’s hot and has a really nice face…and voice… and body.*

Pfft that was just normal crush stuff!

It’s not like it even mattered how her eyes were literally the most perfect shade of blue that Catra actually felt like she’s couldn’t breathe when staring at them for too long;

And it definitely doesn’t matter that even just the sight of her makes Catras heart beat so fast she felt like she’d implode at any

moment;

And it most certainly, most definitely, does **not** matter that she is completely, and utterly, in love with her.

shit

Okay… so *maybe* Catra liked adora like, a tiny bit…

It's not like that even matters anyways

She could still remember the first (and last) time she tried telling Adora about her feelings.

It had been during one of their sleepovers and Catra had casually mentioned how she really liked being with Adora, just the two of them.
And it had been seconds after that, that Adora had hit her with:

"Awh Catra, I really like you too! That's why we're besties "

*Right... **besties.***
Because adora doesn't want her, not like she wants Adora.

God, Catra couldn't even begin to count the number of times she'd replayed that conversation in her head as she'd tried to get to sleep,
besties playing on repeat.

Although, that was never as bad as when she had to choke back the sobs from escaping her mouth after she'd had a nightmare.

On those nights she'd only find comfort in the soft embrace of a certain blonde pulling her under the covers, whispering gentle reassurances in her ear

"…it's okay Catra, I'm here, everything going to be okay, I'm with you, we're together…"

Catra would fall asleep to the soft lull of Adoras voice, her long fingers combing through her hair, gently working through any knots met along the way, Catras face nestled into her neck.

When she woke, Adoras face was always mere inches from hers.

The girl almost looked peaceful like this, her usually hardened jaw unclenched, the lines that so often marked her forehead a mere whisper, soft breaths escaping from slightly parted lips…

It always amused Catra how these were the only nights Adora seemed to sleep peacefully

Probably because she was exhausted from being woken up at 3 in the morning by your sniffling.

There was one thing however, that Catra just couldn't figure out

Why had Adora stayed outside the door for so long?

Catra had basically been suffocating (not exactly in a bad way) in her scent.
How Lonnie didn't smell it, Catra'd never know.

Dumb Etherians with their weakass noses

The time that followed had been the beginning of the worst weeks of her life, worse yet were Shadow Weavers taunts plaguing her every thought:

I've kept you around because Adora was fond of you. You have never been anything more than a nuisance…

She had come extremely close to believing that was the end for her. That as soon as Shadow Weaver had found herself an excuse, she'd be shipped off to beast island.

It was one of the reasons Catra had swallowed her pride to confront adora because, although showing weakness was the worst thing imaginable,

Not being with Adora was worse.

God was a sap

And like, sure it's weird to see your best friend getting fucked by someone she so called hates, but it's not like adora had to be a total asshole to everyone after it.
Especially not to Catra, right?

Honestly sometimes Catra wished she could figure out what was going on in the tightly wound brain of hers.

Ugh, that's more than enough self-pitying to last like, a lifetime

Besides, now Catra thought about it, maybe it was time she tried to have a little fun with Adora...
Harmless, of course.

It's not like flirting with Adora could do any harm right?

Especially when Adora didn't even know why she was doing it.

Catra curled up on the edge of her best friends' bed later that night with a mind overflowing with possibilities of how she could have her fun, not knowing her soonest opportunity would be the very next day…

"Ballroom dancing… Shadow Weaver has got to be having a laugh"

"Come on Catra, don't be like that. She said it would help with our foot work and precision in battle!"

"Oh, I'm sorry, I completely forgot we were planning on beating the Rebellion through a *dance battle* Adora."

The girl huffed,
"Okay fine, it sounds silly when you put it like that. But this'll be fun! And we can be partners!"

Adora looked down at her

"Please? For me?"

*Now that was just **totally** unfair*

"Ugh fine! But I am not being the princess."

"Yes!"

The blonde let out a little squeal as he grabbed at Catras hands that she found way to adorable
(get it? ADORA-ble? God who knows why every girl at the Horde wasn't falling for Catra, she's hilarious!),

"I knew you'd be excited Catra! Now come on, Shadow Weaver said we couldn't wear training clothes for this"

Oh yippee, they got to play dress up on top of playing dance battles

By the time the squad had finally got to the training room, they looked like they'd been attacked by clowns.

Only Adora had managed to look somewhat decent in a red satin knee length dress that perfectly showed off her sculpted figure, hair pinned just above her shoulders allowing for their definition to be shown in all their glory.

Okay fine, she looked incredible

Catra also liked to think she was looking at least somewhat nice in her suit.
I mean, she had tackled kyle over it; there was no way on Etheria that she would be caught dead in the pink tutu he was currently sporting.

“Dancing was once considered to be the most dangerous weapon a soldier could have. The attention to detail to truly master such an art is why I have so little faith in all of you – except of course you my darling Adora”

Shadow weaver gave Adora a smile, although it looked more like a grimace in catras opinion,
To which she responded with by awkwardly shifting from foot to foot.

Hearing Shadow Weaver call Adora ‘her darling’ made Catras tail thrash behind her, Adora placed a gentle arm on her shoulder to calm her.

“Now pair up and spread out across the floor. Because there’s an odd number, Adora you can be with me.”

“Oh uh… I’m already with Catra, uh ma’am.”

“Catra hm? I suppose if you don’t mind getting hair all over you… Right, Kyle, you’re with me. And honestly child, is that really the best outfit you could find?”

Catra shot him a *don’t you even dare think about ratting me out* look as he shuffled over to join Shadow Weaver, muttering about nothing being his size.

“You ready, partner?”

Adoras voice in her ear made Catras heart jump. I mean really, isn’t it unfair for one person to have so much control over another?

“Sure thing princess. And don’t worry, I’ll go slow on you”

Catra gave her a quick wink before sauntering off to the far side of the room. She could have sworn Adoras eyes had widened a little at that.

yeah, she could get used to this

Lonnie and Rogelio were doing relatively well, though the boys large frame made him rather clumsy, highlighted by the frequent yelps from Lonnie when getting her feet stepped on.

As for Kyle and Shadow Weaver… let's just say Catra would pay good money to see Kyles face up close.

Now Adora and Catra? They seemed to be the only pair actually managing to dance well.

Just like when sparring, they worked effortlessly with eachother. Their movements blended together with such fluidity it was hard to tell where one began and the other started.

"Catra, you do know ties are meant to be done up right?"

No

"Yes"

"Then why is it, y'know, undone?"

Because I don't know how to do one and didn't want to ask for help…

"What? Don't like the view?"
Catra was *very* aware of how low she had buttoned her shirt

"Wha- Catra!" Adora spluttered

"Relax, I was joking"

kind of

"I just didn't like how the fabric felt around my neck. Felt like I was being choked"
She gave a slight shrug.

The word ‘choked’ seemed to make Adora flush as red as her dress. She quickly averted her eyes away from Catras to the floor.

why was she… oh right, Lonnie.
She wondered how long Adora’d keep up this little charade of not knowing…
*Huh, maybe this **could** be fun…*

“What’s got you so flustered princess? Surely you wouldn’t want to see me getting choked out, right?”

“I’m not flustered! I-I mean, I’m fine. Just…concentrating… on the steps”

“Mmhmm” Catra let out a soft chuckle
“God, could you imagine what’d it be like to get choked Adora? Especially by a person? Their hand gripping around your throat until you feel lightheaded… What do you reckon that’s like?”

“What the- Why are you asking me that Catra? Of course I don’t know what it’s liked to be choked..”,
A beat of silence passed between them,
“do-do you?”

“Do I what?”

“Um… y’know… know what it’s like to be uh… choked..?”

Ooo somebodies feeling bold today aren’t they

“No.”

“N-no?”

“Nope. Why? Do you think I should?”

“What! Why would you even- what o-of course not no! No, I was just… curious. That’s all”

"That's funny, because you seemed awfully surprised at the fact I said no, princess"

Adoras face had begun to colour slightly

"I wasn't surpised! I just thought maybe in like, training or something, someone could have like, done it…"

"Someone in training? Like who, Kyle? Hah no way. Hmm what about Rogelio? Nah he's way to soft. Oh! I've got it! Lonnie! Oh yeah, she'd totally be the type to choke me out.
Don't you think Adora?"

"Wha- Oh I uh… I wouldn't say like *definitely* Lonnie, or anything. I mean y'know without evidence and all…"

"So you're saying there's absolutely zero evidence that Lonnie would want to choke me? Like, not even the fact she hates me? How odd"

Oh yeah, Adora was *definitely* blushing now

"W-well it's not, like y'know, **that** odd. Cause you guys like… you guys don't really… aren't really… y'know like, together… that often…"

God she was cute when she was flustered. Maybe Catra'd have to start doing this more often…

"I suppose you're right. I mean imagine, Me and Lonnie? Hah! there's no way"

"Hah, yeah, no way…"

Catra spun Adora outwards, a sly smirk playing at her lips.

*Oh yeah, this is gonna be **so** cool*

Catra dropped Adora down into a low dip, their faces so close she could feel Adoras breath tickling her nose.

“Imagine if **you** choked me princess”

If Catra wasn’t sure that Adora had been blushing before? Well let’s just say now, she definitely was, the blonde was practically glowing from how red her cheeks were.

God, she was so good at this.
Catra Applesauce Meowmeow, wooer of girls since –

“That really would be something, huh kitten?”

Fuck.

“Wha- Catra! What was that for!”

A vague picture of Adora lying sprawled out on the floor played in front of her.

Hang on, why was Adora on the floor? Wasn’t she just holding her?
And who the hell was Catra?
Wait a minute – SHE was Catra!

“Oh shit sorry, I uh, I thought I saw a mouse”

Adora chuckled as she picked herself up

“a mouse? Wher-
OH MY GOSH CATRA WATCH OUT THERE’S LITERALLY A MOUSE BEHIND YOU!”

“WHAT WHERE?!!”

Catra practically launched herself onto the other girl, clambering up until her legs hooked just above Adoras waist; the blonde practically trembling with laughter below.

“What’s so funny?”

“You’re so easy Catra! Every time… you fall for it every…time”
She was practically wheezing with laughter at that point.

Fine, two can play at that game

"Adora! That's totally unfair." She pouted slightly,
"It's not like I'd use your fear of… of… Oh no! BETRAYAL! Adora catch me, I'm going to faint it's so scary!"

With that she toppled them both onto the floor.
Catra landing on top of Adora in a heap, both in small fits of giggles.

"Catra! I told you that in confidence! If you're not careful I might just betray **you.**"

Catra knew Adora meant it as a joke, but the words still caused a momentary falter in her laugh

"Hey, Catra? You know I'm only playing right?"

Adora smiled up at her, gazing straight into her eyes.

Oh god, here comes that suffocating feeling again

Catras tail twitched slightly as she looked away. Adora was so close… and she had that stupid dopey grin on her face…

They locked eyes again, Adoras laughter dulling to no more than heavy breaths.

She had that look in her eyes. The one she sometimes got after their late night talks, when the whispers and giggles stopped and it was just them looking at each other, face to face, noses to nose.

Adora swallowed, her lips slightly parting.

Catra couldn't help as her eyes flitted towards them,
they looked so soft…so pink…
She wondered what'd it be like to feel them against her skin, to feel them against her lips…

Slowly, she inched her face closer to Adoras, hearing the girls breath hitch in her throat, her eyes glancing down towards Catras lips,

*Holy shit did- did adora want to… **kiss** her?*

Their faces were now mere centimetres apart, if she just moved slightly clos-

"CATRA! REMOVE YOURSELF FROM ADORA AT ONCE!"

Catra ears stood on end as every hair on her body stood to attention, the shrill voice advancing on them.

"Get off of her now! She may be hurt! And stop shoving your face so close to hers, she might get sick!"

A tidal wave of embarrassment hit her as a deep heat crept up her neck and face, Adora clearly feeling it too as the red flush reappeared upon her own.

Neither girl could find themselves able to look at the other.

Catra could just about hear Lonnie sniggering to Rogelio from the other side of the room and flashed her what she hoped was a murderous glare, however with her face on fire most likely looked like an anxious glance.

Kyle on the other hand was struggling to drag Catra up off the ground, as insisted by Shadow Weaver in order for her to 'rescue' Adora, per se.

"I've got it Kyle!" she snapped,
"You can stop man handling me now, jeez."

He jumped back, clearly worried about getting slashed by Catras claws which had extended.

"S-sorry Catra"

“Ugh, whatever, just get out of my way.”

She trudged past him towards the changing rooms.

“Careful Catra, Shadow Weaver might start to think you’ve got a crush on her precious little Adora; and I’m sure that would go down really well considering her thoughts on you”
For fucks sake, why did Lonnie have to be the one to find her after that stupid fucking argument

“Fuck off Lonnie.”

“Or what Catra? Are you gonna beg me? We both know you’ve already had some practice”
Lonnies lips arched into a smirk

fuck this bitch

Catra slammed Lonnie up against the wall, gripping at the girls… dress? (If you could call it that)

“I’m going to say this once Lonnie”,
She practically snarled her words, pinning Lonnies throat between the wall with her forearm,

“What we’ve done only happened because I was bored. You’re not special and I **don’t** like Adora. Do you understand me?”

The taller girl struggled for breath as she matched Catras intense glare.

“I-”
Lonnies words came out as an intangible string

“Hm? What was that?”

“I said, I think you need to chill, the fuck, out”

Catra applied some more pressure against Lonnies throat, a terrifying calm washing over her as she sighed

“Why don’t we try that again Lonnie”, She cocked her eyebrows, “Do. You. Under. Stand.”

Clearly realising Catra had the upper hand, Lonnie let out a huff.

“Yes, I fucking understand!”

“Good.”, Catra gave a slight smile which immediately dropped, “Now fuck off.”

Catra tossed her to the side, marching through the changing room doors as Lonnie yelled after her trying to get the last words

“Don’t get too comfortable pushing people around Catra! We both know Adora won’t put up with you forever, and good luck with Shadow Weaver when that finally happens.”

Like Catra could ever forget.

She walked straight past the bunks, heading for the door to the roof.
Maybe then it would stop feeling like the walls were trying to swallow her.

Stupid Shadow Weaver. Stupid Lonnie. Stupid Fucking Catra.

Of course Adora hadn’t wanted to kiss her! What was she even thinking? That she had somehow managed to ‘woo’ her into liking girls? Honestly how thick was she! And on top of that? Shadow Weaver had another dumb fucking reason to hate her.

And of course there was Adora. Perfect Little Adora who hadn’t said *anything*

Why couldn’t she choose Catra just once!? Why did she always have to put her stupid fucking ‘destiny’ above of them?

It wasn’t fair. Nothing was ever fair.

The cold whipped at Catras face like sheets of ice. It was only then that she realised tears were spilling over her cheeks, threatening to never stop.

why did she even bother? Its not like she’ll ever get what she wants here.

Catra had contemplated running away from the horde a bunch of times, but right now? Sitting on top of some creaky, rusty tower?

Catra didn’t even know if there was a point in **any of it** anymore. Everywhere she’d go Shadow Weaver would just haunt her, lurking in the dark…
Watching her.

Everything started happening at once:
Her heart began beating too quickly, blood pounding in her ears; her hands trembled as her vision blurred; she couldn’t breathe, everything had gone dry, even her tears has stopped.
what the fuck was happening to her…
Her head felt dizzy, everything feeling so, so far away… like she could just jump and never hit the ground…

So why didn’t she? Why didn’t she just-

“Catra?!”

…that voice… she recognised that voice… Adora… Adora had come to save her like she always did…

Catra felt the world begin to slip away, allowing the sensations to engulf her.

Chapter End Notes

> Catra going from cocky to flustered in 0.2 seconds gives me life

Baby catra just needs soemone to hug her
its a head canon of mine that catra gets panic attacks but, being in the horde, just has no idea what to do when it happens so i tried my best to embody that here however as i don't personally experience them i tried my best to research how they feel so i am very sorry if any of it is inaccurate - please let me know if thats the case so i can edit/remove it

i'll try to update atleast once a week, maybe two if lucky, as i have exams in a couple weeks

ily all and thank you sm for reading !! <3 :)

enough to pierce my heart

Chapter Notes

hiiii <3 sorry this ones a bit later than usual but life's been kinda hectic!! eek and i'm getting a kitten!!!
anyways hope you like it :))) !

also this is definitely going to be more than 4 chapters!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adoras POV

Adora had no clue where she was going or what she was doing. Catra in lay limp in her arms, tail dragging along the floor, ears drooped to the side of her head. She didn't understand what had happened. One minute Catra had been on the roof staring out over the fright zone and the next?
She had just… collapsed.

The blonde was sure there must be some logical explanation for it, however the Horde didn't exactly teach health classes – other than how to fight on a broken bone but that seemed pretty irrelevant right now.

Another thought that kept distracting her was how close Catra had been to not being in her arms right now.
Everything had happened so suddenly Adora barely had enough time to register the brunette falling over the edge before she caught her by the tail (something she was sure Catra wouldn't appreciate later but hey, she'd appreciate death less)
She tried not to imagine what could've happened had her reaction time been slower…

Atleast there was one thing she could thank Horde training for

It was exactly these kinds of thoughts that made her oblivious to the looming figure ahead of her, that was until she quite literally had her face in it.

"OOF!"

The low noise came from the incredibly tall person towering over Adora, who was now sprawled out on the floor; Catra still clutched tightly to her chest. She wished they could've been swallowed up by the floor when she noticed a glinting green force captain badge on their chest.

Adora knew Catra would rather die than let anyone, especially Shadow Weaver, see her like this. Therefore adora made it her sworn duty to make sure that never happened.

How hard can acting really be?

"Oh gosh, are you okay!?" strangely, the voice was filled with concern.
must just be a trick to get me to spill everything

"M-me okay? I'm great! I think the real question is are *you* okay!
"I uh- what?"
"Yes! You don't look too good. In fact… I bet you don't even realise you're dreaming right now, do you! That's right… this is allll a dream."

Oh yeah, she was crushing it

"…dreaming? But it's the middle of the afternoon? And usually my dreams involve a lot of singing…"

goddammit, singing? Really?

"But you'reee wronggg, this is allll a hallucinationnn…"
Adora swayed herself side to side as she tried her best at singing her words, the force captains face told her they weren't convinced.
time for plan B – distraction

Adora noticed a sign behind the figure and couldn't believe her luck:
"Ah but it is a dream! There's even a 'free hugs' club right behindddd youuu"
That really was odd, the Horde never did clubs

"Why would that make this a dream? It's my club!"
"Exac- uh, what?" that caught her totally of guard
"Yeah! 'Scorpias Free Hugs Club'! I just started it so numbers are still pretty low, I mean its uh, its just me right now… but I'm sure other people will come when the word spreads!"

What on Etheria? Adora had never met a cadet like this before
Although now she thought about it, the girl in front of her, Scorpia, did look different from other Horde soldiers. Other than her short platinum white hair and uh- pincers, she had little crinkles beside her eyes, rather than on her forehead like Adora had. Not to mention the fact she was literally beaming down at her even after being lied to, something most force captains would probably fight you for.

"Are you sure everything's okay? Your friend really looks like they need some help. Here, if I just take you to Shado-"

"NO! I uh- sorry um no, no need. We're perfectly fine, this is just a game of ours we like to play, right?" Adora wiggled the unconscious Catras head in agreement,
"See! Absolutely fine!" She tried her best to smile but from the look on Scorpias face it had come off a lot more strained than intended.

"Hey look, don't worry, I won't tell Shadow Weaver. How about you guys just come with me to my room and you can carry on with your uh…game… there?"
Adora couldn't figure out why Scorpia was being so nice to her, but she was pretty sure a person with giant pincers and spikes on their shoulders isn't someone you should refuse.

Besides, she has a hug club! How bad can she be?

***

Very bad
It wasn't even that Scorpia was being violent towards them, it was the fact she was being so *nice* that put Adora on edge.
Like at any moment Shadow Weaver would just jump out of the shadows and rip Catra away from her…

On top of that, Scorpia was a *really* big hugger. Like massively big. Adora wasn't sure she'd had even a minute to herself since being with the force captain.

"Wow, isn't it crazy how the world works? I woke up thinking today would be a normal day and then BAM! I have two new best friends!"

that was one way of looking at it…

"Haha yeah it sure is crazy… so um, Scorpia, I was wondering if you knew what was wrong with my friend?"
Adora hadn't told Scorpia Catras name yet, partly out of fear she might tell someone and party for a reason she didn't quite understand.

"Well from what you've said, it seems like she had a panic attack and ended up passing out after. She's breathing fine and has a slightly fast pulse… though that might just be a magicat thing…"

a magi-what now?

"But other than that all she needs it rest and water when she wakes up! And don't worry, you can totally stay here until that happens!"
Scorpia beamed at Adora again and the girl got a feeling that she didn't get to spend time with people that often.

"Uh sure, thanks Scorpia." She gave a small smile
"No problem Sunflower!"

Adoras face clearly looked as puzzled as she felt because the tall girl immediately launched into an explanation,
"Ah it's just a little nickname I came up with for you! I called your friend here Wildcat", Scorpia waggled her pincers in the air when saying the name, "just thought it fit y'know?"

No. Adora didn't know. How could Scorpia possibly know so much about Catra from spending two minutes with her ***unconscious*** *body to make her a nickname? Specially to come up with one that managed to fit her…*

Adora felt her stomach tighten slightly at her thoughts though she was unsure as to why, Scorpia was just trying to help. She shoved it away by changing the subject.

"So Scorpia, what's it like being a force captain? I bet it's awesome! It's my dream to be one someday! My friend and I, we're gonna be captains together one day", a small smile played on her face at the thought of Catra saying how they'd rule Etheria together one day.

"Oh yeah its- it's great, it's really great. So much fun uh, ordering people around all day…"
"I bet it is! How'd you become one anyways? Usually cadets have to do something crazy great to be considered given the badge!"

Scorpia shifted uncomfortably at the question, her eyes flitting to something on the nightstand behind Adoras back. She took a slight breath before answering,
"My mums they uh, they used to rule the land the Fright Zone's built on. But when Hordak came along they let him use it for his army in return he promised them I'd be made a captain."
"They ruled the land? That makes it sound like they were queens! That'd make you a princess! Imagine that! A Princess as a force captain? HA! That's hilarious!"

Scorpias cheeks flushed as her eyes shot to the floor. Her next words came out barely a whisper
"I um… I am a princess sunflower… just not a very good one…"

Adora didn't understand.
"What?! That cant be right! Princesses are blood thirsty evil doers! Why would Hordak ever make a princess a force captain?!"

Shadow Weaver had always told them that no princess could be saved, that they all were hardwired to want power and control over Etheria… so how could Scorpia be telling her the truth?
but why would she lie?
It was Adoras turn to burn red now, for the look on Scorpias face told her she wasn't lying and that Adora had definitely hit a nerve somewhere in her stupid speech.

"Oh Scorpia, I didn't mean that you don't deserve to be force captain! I just, I'm a little surprised that you're a… y'know, princess…"

Scorpias smile returned to her face, so big Adora was sure the girls cheeks must be constantly aching.
"Don't worry about it Sunflower! Lotsa people don't know that about me, you do get taught it in force captain orientation though and *boy* was that an awkward situation…" Scorpias smile faltered slightly at the memory,
"Anyways! I've gotta head out to do some uh, force captainy stuff, and you need to stay with Wildcat here. And don't worry, I'll be back later with food from the canteen, I heard they're doing the grey bars tonight! They're the best ones!"

Scorpia seemed to spend a lot of time trying to get people not to worry, Adora wondered if there was a reason for it. Before she got a chance to ask however, the much taller girl was gone, walking with a slightly too straight back for it to be considered casual.

Adora let out a long sigh. Thank stars training had been cancelled for the rest of the day due to the ballroom fiasco, at least she won't get in trouble for missing anything.
Adoras eyes wandered over to Catra lying on Scorpias bed, swaddled in blankets.

Her eyes fluttered slightly as she slept, her breathing slow and steady.
Adora could still see the fur on her face was damp with tears.
She had wondered why Catra had been crying on top of the roof when she found her a few times. Sure it was awkward to be yelled at by Shadow Weaver, but Catra never cried over those sorts of things; that was Kyles job!

She had been vaguely aware of Lonnie and Catra speaking whilst Shadow Weaver had coddled over her, checking for broken bones and scars, and she would be lying if she said she hadn't felt a twinge of jealousy over it,
probably just because she wanted to be talking to Catra instead of being swamped with Shadow Weaver
but she didn't know what Lonnie could have said to make Catra cry...

The last time Catra had cried was when she had broken a rib during training a few years back, and even then, only a few tears fell.
Anything close to weakness terrified Catra.

In fact, Adora barely saw her letting herself be vulnerable at all! The most recent being when she'd asked Adora if she hated her. That had really scared Adora if she was being honest, Catra had looked so frightened…

But this? Catras fur literally matted with tears? Adora had never seen her like this.
She couldn't place what had gone wrong. They'd been having so much fun dancing together and Catra had been really… well, she wasn't sure what exactly but it had seemed good, and then Catra had dropped her after she tried getting back at Catras teasing…

(something that had made Adoras heart beat way too fast)

And then they were on top of each other…
Even the thought of that moment brought heat rushing to Adoras cheeks.

Catra had been so close to her, their faces barely inches away, and Adora had got that **feeling** again, the one she sometimes got late at night in her bunk when they lay facing each other only inches away; and Catra… it looked like she had it too…

Why did Catra being so close to her make her feel so reckless? Like she'd risk everything to do *something*.
And *why* couldn't she just figure out **what** that something was!
Then there was the way Catras eyes had flicked downwards and Adoras had to, her eyes trained on Catras lips as their heads inched closer together…

Thinking about it made Adoras head throb. She knew it all had to mean something, she just didn't know **what**. It was quite literally killing her.

"Oh Catra… what's wrong with me?"
Her voice felt far too echoey in the silent room, the only other noise being Catras soft breaths.
Adora did something rather unusual next, she took the time to think about her feelings.
Despite much preferring to punch out whatever was bothering her in training, it was currently cancelled and she couldn't leave Catra to sneak in to the gym… so thinking was the only option.

She couldn't remember when the feeling had started just that it had, and that it made it really difficult to be close to Catra.
Instead of thinking straight her thoughts became all wiggly, swirling inside her head, making her incapable of forming a coherent sentence.
Her heart would start beating faster every time Catras eyes flicked from her own, sending Adoras mind into overdrive as thoughts of *what is she looking at? is she judging me? do I look bad?* swarmed her head.
Whenever Catra curled into Adoras chest, purring gently against her skin, she felt as if her lungs had filled up with water. Adora thought she would quite happily drown in the sound of Catras purrs if she could.

*But what did it all **mean?** Why did Catra make her feel this way?*
Adora wished she could talk to Catra about it but she feared the girl would be freaked out by her. I mean, what normal person stops breathing when their best friend holds their hand? Why did it all have to be so confusing!

Adora wished some magical fairy lady would just appear and tell her what was going on. At least then Adora could stop thinking there was something wrong with her.
…was it bad to feel nervous around your best friend? To want their hand to stay on yours just that little bit longer? To want them to lean in just that little bit closer…
Why was she thinking these things!

***

Adora was huddled on the floor, knees pulled tightly to her chest with her head buried between them, when an all too cheery Scorpia re-entered the room.

"I've got dinner! I snagged us all the grey kind too! Sunflower? Sunflo-",
Scorpias voice cut off as her eyes settled on Adora, shaking in the corner of the room,

"Oh sunflower, what's wrong? It's okay come here, don't worry"
Scorpias voice was soft as she dropped to the floor in front of Adora, pulling her into a close hug, the ration bars discarded somewhere unimportant.
Adora looked up, her tear-stained face meeting Scorpias worried one,

"what's wrong with me Scorpia? Am I sick?"
Adora knew she looked pathetic, her voice shaking so much she barely managed to speak, but right now she couldn't bring herself to care. She was terrified. She had no clue what was going on or why she felt the things she did. In this moment all she wanted was to be cared for and she thanked her lucky stars that somehow she had found Scorpia on this day.

“Shhh Sunflower, nothing’s wrong with you. Its all going to be okay, I promise you”
Scorpia continued hugging and reassuring Adora until her breath had slowed and her shoulders were no longer shaking.
“Now I know its none of my business sunflower but, do you want to talk about it? I swear with my whole heart I wont ever tell a soul if you wish me not to.”

Something about Scorpia made Adora feel safe with her. Like whatever she said would never be used against her, no matter what happened.
And so she did. She told Scorpia everything:
About her need to please Shadow Weaver and always be the best, her want to protect people, even her doubts about what the Horde was doing – something she’d never told *anybody* before, not even Catra.

When she got on to Catra the overwhelming feeling hit her again and tears began sliding down her cheeks. Scorpia simply held onto her until they had subsided and then listened, really listened, to what Adora said about the weird feelings she felt.
Scorpia had a knowing look on her face and a soft smile on her lips when Adora had finished. Her kind, caring eyes on her almost set Adora off crying again; this time however, she managed to hold back her tears. Finally, when Adora was done, Scorpia began to speak;

“Oh Sunflower you poor thing, you’ve been keeping this all to yourself this entire time it’s no wonder you’ve been feeling so disorientated. I wish I could tell you why you’re feeling like this but that’s a question only you can answer.
But I can tell you this;
"When we feel things we don’t understand, it’s usually because we won’t let ourselves understand them. Be it out of fear, or anger, sometimes we just aren’t ready to face them yet. And that’s okay sunflower! That’s so okay! It doesn’t mean you’re sick, or that there’s something wrong with you, it just means you need some more time. When you’re ready to face them, you will. And I hope you know I’ll be here for you when the time comes.”

Adora could only stare at the girl in front of her dumbfounded. Where she'd learnt such compassion and wisdom in the Horde was beyond her.
"You barely know me Scorpia, why are you being so nice?"

"Because Adora, I felt like you for a very long time and I really needed someone to be there for me. The best I can do now is try and be there for you."
Adora didn't even question how Scorpia knew her name. All she could feel was an overwhelming sense of gratitude for her.

"…thank you Scorpia."
"Anytime Sunflower." Scorpia gave her another warm smile when a sound from the bed alerted them,

"Wildcat! You're awake, brilliant! I've got us all the grey ration bars tonight! They're the best ones!"
The confused look on Catras face quickly switched to a protective one when she saw Adora huddled on the floor in front of her,

"What are you doing to her! Adora get away from her!" Catras claws had unsheathed by the time Adora scrambled over to her.

"Catra, hey, I'm okay. Scorpia and I were just talking. She's let us stay here all day after I ran into her with you."
Scorpia chuckled at this, evidently remembering the quite literal meaning behind Adoras words. That only made Catra scowl more, the hair stiffening on her head.
Adora quickly pulled her into a hug, feeling Catras shoulders loosen slightly,

"I was so worried about you Catra. Up on the roof, I didn't know what happened but Scorpia explained you'd had a panic attack and-"

"I didn't have a panic attack." Catra said it deadpan, but the tension in her shoulders made it clear the thought scared her.
"Catra it's okay, you don't need to be ashamed of it! Scorpia said that lots of people get them and-"

“Did *scorpia* say anything else to you? Or did she just talk about how pathetic I am the whole time?” Catra practically spat Scorpias name from her mouth.

“Catra no that’s not what i-“
“Wildcat, panic attacks don’t make you pathetic! They just mean your bodies overstimulated due to exterior situations-”
“Firstly, I’m not your *Wildcat*. Secondly, you don’t know anything about me so stop acting like you do,”
“Catra! Scorpia helped you why are yo-“
“and thirdly *Adora*, I don’t need you to save me. I’m not some weak baby that needs protecting, okay?! So stop acting like I need you because I don’t!”

With that Catra sprang off the bed charging out of the door. Adora felt her heart plummet as she turned to the other girl.
“Scorpia I’m so sorry. She’s not very good with new people and she was scared because you saw her when she was really vulnerable and i-“
“Hey, Sunflower, it’s okay. It’s like you said, she’s scared right now and so she became defensive. I think you should probably go after her Sunflower; people do stupid things when they’re scared…”

Scorpia looked grim for the first time since Adora had met her, but she chose not comment on it. Instead, she took the ration bars gratefully and gave Scorpia a small smile as she head out after Catra, her heart feeling slightly lighter than it had before.

Chapter End Notes

> Look at my baby scorpia being her perfect self! <3 i wonder how things would've been if adora and/or catra had met her before adora left the horde...
>
> Thanks for reading you guys!! i'm still shocked people actually read my work like??? it sucks??? but i love you all!!!! drink water and have a snack if you haven't ate in a while <333

a promise from me to you

Chapter Notes

This is a hefty one!! I really loved writing it and got so engrossed i didn't even notice it go over 6000 words until the end!
i only managed to do a quick speed check so please ignore any dumb mistakes :D

Hope you enjoy! A pretty fluffy chapter overall with a little bit of angst and mild smut that can be skipped over

They really have my whole heart <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catras POV

Catra wished she hadn't run off before snatching one of the ration bars up, her stomach felt like an empty void. However she was also stubborn as a cow, so there was no way on Etheria she would take help from that big oaf Adora had called 'Scorpia'.

God, they might as well be best friends from the way Adora had defended her.

Catra knew it was stupid to be mad at her for this she hadn't even done anything, other than try to help Catra. Nevertheless, jealousy got the better of her as it usually did when in regards to Adora. She'd been huddled up behind one the huge crates in the storage room trying to figure out what Adora and Scorpia could've possibly been talking about to make her so puffy eyed, when heavy thumps entered the room.

Please don't be Adora
Catra really didn't want to face her right now, she'd probably end up saying something she didn't mean just to get a reaction.

Her thoughts were cut off however, when a slightly less familiar voice filled the room.

"Oi Catra? I brought you a ration bar from the canteen; it's the brown ones though cause some big chick took three of the grey ones. I would've said something but she had some massive pincers and I'm pretty sure you don't mess with massive pincers…"
Catra stayed silent as the person let out a huff,
"Look Catra, I know you're in here so can you stop moping about and just come out already."

"I'm gay."

"Yeah, no shit, it's not like I haven't been fucking you for the past few months."

Catra rolled her eyes as she slunk out from behind her crate, avoiding Lonnie's eyes whilst proceeding to clamber on top. Being up high always made Catra feel safer, maybe it was a cat thing. She let out a sigh, "What do you want Lonnie?"

"I already told you, I brought you some food. And you missed lunch so I kinda guessed you'd be hungry by now, what with your fast metabolism and all."

Oddly, Lonnie looked at bit sheepish as she held out the ration bar. Catra raised her eyebrows at the girl, it wasn't often that people other than Adora were nice to her; especially Lonnie. Unless they'd just slept together, which they hadn't exactly been doing a whole lot of lately; still, it was kind of… nice? Weird? Catra didn't really know.
"So, what're you doing out here?"

Catra let out a dry laugh. Lonnie wasn't exactly what one would call sympathetic and she didn't doubt Lonnie would just make fun of her if she knew about Catra passing out.
and no, it most definitely ***wasn't*** *from a panic attack*
"Why are you talking to me Lonnie? You hate my guts unless

we're fucking."
Lonnie looked slightly taken aback at the statement,
"Stars Catra, I don't hate you, none of us hate you, but you block us out so it's not exactly easy to talk to you. That, or it's because you're scary as fuck. I'm pretty sure Kyle almost wets himself every time you go near him."

Catra rolled her eyes, a small smile on her lips matched by the one on Lonnie's,
"And I'm not saying I *like* you or anything, just that it's almost curfew and we all get in trouble if you're not back in time."

Something tugged in Catra's stomach,
"Is uh, is Adora back?"

"Oh right, Adora… yeah she's back; really wants to talk to you too. Keeps nagging all of us about whether or not we've seen you, said she's looked everywhere."

Catra didn't doubt Adora had, that was just the kind of person she was. Still, she hadn't found her even when Lonnie had managed to…
"Whatever, it's not like she *actually* likes me. She's just got to be hero all the time."

Lonnie looked like she was about to slap Catra.
"You have **got** to be fucking kidding me right now. Do you honestly think Adora doesn't like you?", Catra shrugged, "Holy shit Catra, I thought you were meant to be smart."
She gave Lonnie a disgruntled look, Catra didn't like to be called dumb.

"The way she acts, it's like she's in love with you or something!", Catra felt her cheeks burn,
"Honestly, why can't you accept that people can like you without having some stupid-ass ulterior motives? It's really fucking stupid."

"Yeah, alright Lonnie I get it, I'm dumb." She rolled her eyes for what felt like the hundredth time,

“Look, I’ll be back by curfew just, go tell Adora to stop fretting okay? And thanks for the food…even if it is the brown ones.”

Lonnie huffed a laugh as she walked out the room, throwing her middle finger over her shoulder to where Catra was still sat.
She hated to admit it but Lonnie had a point.
It wasn’t exactly easy for someone to become Catra's friend and yet, Adora had still managed – that had to mean something right?

***

As promised, she got back to the bunks just as Shadow Weaver came to wish them good night (if screaming at them to get in their bunks counted as a goodnight). Lonnie flashed her a quick nod which Catra reciprocated as she hurried over to her and Adora’s beds.
She knew from the way the blonde kept stealing glances at her that she wanted to talk, so Catra did the only thing she thought would break the weird tension between them:
She tackled Adora to the floor.

“Catra! Get off!” Adora’s seemingly harsh words were dampened by the giggling laughter lacing them.
“What? A little birdie told me you missed me.” Catra wiggled her eyebrows whilst booping Adora on the forehead.

“Ugh, you’re so annoying!”, still giggling, “but I did miss you. I tried looking for you but you’re pretty good at hiding from me when you want to...” Adora’s laughing stopped, replaced by a self-conscious look Catra didn’t like one bit.

“Not everything’s about you Adora! I simply enjoy my own company ‘sall” Catra smirked at the girl, relaxing as she did the same.
“Now seriously Catra get off, Shadow Weaver will have a fit if we don’t get into bed soon!”

All the more reason to not

Reluctantly, Catra rolled off of Adora, reaching her hand out to pull the blonde up. She had felt a little guilty about running off earlier but she was glad at least that Adora didn't seem mad at her for it.
Adora snuggled onto her bed as Catra made for the ladder, when she felt a slight tug on her tail,

"Where are you going?" Adora whispered up at her from the bed.
"Um, to my bed?"
"Don't be a dummy, we both know you sleep in mine more than your own. C'mere."

Adora patted the thin mattress beneath her softly. Catra always found herself unable to resist when Adora did that. She knew the girl knew it too, a big dopey grin plastered on her face.

Slowly, she clambered onto the foot on Adora's bed, pawing at it until she got comfy before curling up on her side.
After a few moments of silence she felt a soft prod on her back,

"mmrph?"
"I uh, I'm sorry if I made you feel overwhelmed earlier. I didn't mean too; I was just so happy you were okay…"

Classic Adora, apologising for something she didn't even do

"Sleep tight Catra; I hope you have sweet dreams"
Catra didn't say anything in return, her purrs being answer enough.

Things started going really well after that.
Her and Adora were back to their inseparable selves, something Catra didn't realise had shifted until it had returned. Catra was back to being her normal self, making sure to sometimes growl a little as Kyle walked past her. He always made a high pitched "eep!" that she found hilarious.

As for her and Lonnie…well, barely met up anymore; and if they did all that happened was making out.
It was obvious Lonnie wanted to do more from the way her hands would roam along Catra's back and thighs, but them two fucking was what got her and Adora into such a mess in the first place, so Catra was perfectly fine just making out.

"Stars Lonnie, you're so good at that…"
Yep, perfectly fine.

"Hmm" Lonnie hummed in reply against her collarbone. The girl had grown accustomed to sucking on just the right places to make Catra breathless.

"…yeah…right there…that's it…" a low growl escaped her lips as Lonnie grazed her teeth on a fresh bruise forming across her chest.

"That's so fucking hot." was all Lonnie said before moving her lips down Catra's chest, her hand moving to rub on her breast eliciting another groan from Catra as she grinded her hips down against Lonnie's thigh

"mmm…don't stop that… feels so fucking good…"

Lonnie pinched Catras nipple between her thumb and finger, tugging at them slightly,
"Oh stars Lonnie… yeah… keep doing that…" her grinding became harder as she thrust herself against Lonnie, a smirk spreading across the other girls face
"You like that, huh kitten?"

Catras breath hitched at the name as she pulled back, the other girl breaking her lips away to see what was wrong.
"Sorry, I just... can you not call me kitten? Please? It um, it feels… wrong…"

"Oh yeah, no problem." Lonnie was already leaning back in as she spoke, her tongue running over Catra's other nipple, encouraging the throbbing between her legs as she ground down onto her.

It felt good, really good.
Catra let out another gasp, as Lonnie nibbled at her nipple gently. The taller girls hand ran up Catra's thigh, groping at it before slipping under her crotch.

Catra thrust down onto it, the hardness rubbing against her clit just right.

She let out another moan, her eyelids fluttering shut,
"…mmh…Lonnie…" her voice was breathy as a hand scratched at the base of her tail, causing her toes to curl.
"…oh stars yes…"

Lonnie's hand began to slip down Catra's pants, immediately making the girl tense up.

"Wait- can we… can we take a break for a minute?" She was still slightly out of breath.

Lonnie leant back again, concerned but also a little annoyed at being stopped.
"What's up?"

"I uh, I think maybe we should stop… doing this… for a bit"
"Huh?"
"Yeah I just, um, I'm just not really that into it…anymore."

Catra knew it was an outright lie but she didn't want to mess up how well things were going with Adora.
Adora…
The throbbing between her legs picked up at that thought, taking all of Catra's will power to not start grinding down on Lonnie's thigh again.

"You're not 'into it'?" Lonnie cocked her left eyebrow slightly, "because you seemed pretty into it when you were moaning against my lips."
Catra blushed a little, reminiscing at the feeling of Lonnie's lips on her.

“Well, I’m just not really feeling it anymore. Sorry”
“You’re lying.”
“What! I am no-“
“Look, I don’t care if you don’t wanna do this anymore; as much as I love fucking you, it’s only fun if we’re both into it. Besides, I kinda guessed something was up when you kept tensing up at my hand going near your clit. But I’m not letting you leave until you stop giving me some bullshit excuse and actually tell me why.”

Ugh, why did she have to be so stubborn.

Catra didn’t say anything, her eyes trailing along Lonnie's toned arms wondering what’d it be like if they were *her* arms…
“It’s Adora, isn’t it?”

Catra practically choked.
“Don’t act so surprised, you couldn’t be more obvious if you wore a sign around your neck saying ‘I’m in love with Adora!’”
“What- I am not in love with her!” She wasn’t sure if she actually knew what ‘ love’ felt like, Shadow Weaver always told her from as young she could remember that she was unlovable, but she wasn’t about to admit that to Lonnie.

The girl let out a long sigh
“Adora, Adora, Adora… it’s always gotta be her huh?” Catra knew what Lonnie was implying but she disliked the tone of voice the girl used in reference to Adora.
“Tell me Catra, why Adora. Hm? What’s so **great** about stupid, fucking, Adora.”

“Don’t call her that.” Catra's voice was cold as ice but steady, unlike Lonnie’s whose only seemed to grow more hysterical each second,
“And why the hell not? S’not like she’ll hear.” Lonnie grabbed Catra's wrists in either hand, clamping them much too tightly.
“You said it yourself Catra, she doesn’t want you. So why haven’t you given up?”

“Lonnie, stop it.”
The girl sneered, her grip only growing tighter as Catra struggled against her.
“C’mon Catra, tell me. Why Adora? Why is it always Adora?”
Lonnie’s face was so close to her own she could feel the girls breath against it.

“Get the fuck off me.” Catra growled her words, trying to jolt her hands away as Lonnie let out a dry laugh.

“So what, you just don’t have an answer? Typical of you really…”
“You don’t know a thing about me” she spat,

“Oh, don’t I? Then tell me you’re not waiting for a girl who will never love you, constantly worrying that she’ll leave when she realises you’re not enough and that when she does, you’re not terrified at Shadow Weaver having no problem shipping you off to beast island.”
Catra remained silent, her ears drawn to the back of her head.
“That's what I thought.”

“Lonnie why are you doing this…”
Catra knew she sounded weak, but she also knew the only way to get Lonnie off of her would be through distracting her long enough to loosen her grip.
“Honestly Catra, I thought you’d figure it out a while back, what with you superior senses and all” Catra simply blinked at her, partly to get her to carry on, and partly because she didn’t know what Lonnie was talking about.
“Smell me.”

the fuck-?

“Stop staring like a dumbass and smell me.”

Catra did as she was told. She didn’t know what she was meant to smell, to her it was just overwhelmingly **Lonnie**. Although, now she *was* trying to smell something different, she noticed a tangy scent tangled up in it…

She'd only smelt that a couple times before, one being when her and Adora had snuck past two older cadets standing awfully close to one another in a doorway;
She'd later found out they'd been making out, but that hadn't really meant anything to an eight-year-old Catra.

"Stars, have I got to spell everything out for you?", Lonnie grumbled under her breath, "I fucking like you, okay?"
"You don't like me, Lonnie. You like having sex with me." Her tone was cold.
"For fuck's sake Catra! Why can't you accept someone liking you? Why have you always gotta be so fucking stubborn!"

Catra burst out in a fit of laughter:
"So what? You like me? Lonnie, half the time… sweet fucks Lonnie, half the time you're trying to kill me! I don't think that's what people do when they're in love." The other girls grip loosened slightly, a sheepish look upon her face,
"Well it's not like they teach you how to express feelings in the Horde Catra! And I didn't say I loved you."

She giggled slightly, knowing that all too well, but hopeful look in Lonnie's eyes brought it to a stop.
She sighed, bringing her gaze to the floor. Catra knew she'd never like Lonnie, not like Lonnie wanted her too.

She'd always be Adora's, whether or not Adora was hers.

"Lonnie I-"
"Save it Catra, I know you like Adora. I just don't understand *why.*", her voice was desperate, "Sure she's the golden girl but, is she really all that?"
Yes
Before Catra could answer and another voice rang through the changing rooms:

"Catraaaa! Are you in…here?" Adora stopped in her tracks, staring frozen at the two girls. Catra suddenly felt very self-conscious without a top on.

You literally get changed together every day, get a hold of yourself!

Adora’s eyes stopped on Catra's wrists, still encased by Lonnie’s hands.
When Catra looked back up at her, Adora had her jaw set. Her back was upright with her feet planted shoulder width apart. Her eyes were trained on Lonnie,
“What do you think you’re doing?”
It wasn’t said like a question, more of a challenge.

Catra couldn’t help but admire the girl. She looked so… powerful.
not the time

“Nothing.” Lonnie spat the words; her eyes still locked on Catra's as she released her grip on her wrists, relief instantly flooding over them.
Without another word Lonnie stormed out of the room, making an obvious effort to shove Adora’s shoulder on her way past. Not that it made much difference, Lonnie may be strong compared to Catra but compared to Adora? She didn’t stand a chance.

The blonde’s stance immediately softened once they were alone, her eyes scanning Catra's face for any signs of discomfort as she pulled her sports bra on over her head.
“Are you okay?”

Adora’s voice was so full of worry she had to look away to stop herself from tearing up. in response to this, the blonde crossed the room, arms out in front of her which soon were wrapping around the much shorter girl.
Something about Adora made her feel so safe. She buried her head into the girl's chest just, letting herself breath.

Catra didn’t care what Lonnie had said, even if Adora would never want her how Catra wanted her, she was okay with it as long as she still got to be held by her.

"I'm okay," she mumbled, "just talking was all."
The hickeys along her neck and chest told anyone it was a lie, but if Adora noticed, she didn't say anything. Catra was grateful for that, she felt exposed at the moment and it wasn't just from being half naked.

Adoras hold loosened as she pulled back, gently picking up the brunette's hands. Catra watched, fixated, as she ran small circles over the marks on her wrists.
"She did this to you." Another not-question question.
She found herself unable to meet the girls eyes, her intense gaze sending chills along Catra's spine. Instead, she kept her eyes trained on Adora's thumbs which were tracing patterns along her forearm. It both tickled and hurt slightly when her fingers brushed over the bruises forming but Catra didn't want her to stop. It felt… nice.

That's one way to say you're fucked up

Something about Adora right then made everything she did so much more intense. Catra knew that if she asked her too, Adora would beat Lonnie to a pulp until she wished her to stop.

Slowly Catra looked up, taking a deep breath to find Adora's eyes still on her. A blush slowly crept up her neck.
Only Adora could make Catra blush with nothing more than a look…

The girl had something else in her eyes too, a gleam that Catra wished she knew the meaning behind.
Catra brought her index finger up to Adora's forehead, poking her right between the eyebrows, grinning;

"You came to find me," Adora simply nodded, "Why?"

A smile spread across the girls' face, "I wanted to show you something!"

Without another word Adora led her out of the changing rooms, being sure to not grasp her wrist too tightly, something she was glad for as they were still quite sore.
After walking for a few minutes Catra laced her fingers through Adora's. They hadn't held hands like this since they were kids, evident in the blondes slightly wide-eyed face. Catra simply stared ahead as they walked, forcing a smile off her face.

Eventually they made it to the bottom of 'their' tower (aka the tallest one in the Fright Zone aka one of Catras favourite places)
"Now, you have to promise me that you won't climb up until I reach the top. Promise?"
Catra rolled her eyes at this, but nodded all the same. One thing Adora could never out do Catra in was climbing, her speed was unmatched by everyone in the Horde.
"Okay, good." Adora flashed her that big goofy grin and started to clamber up the side of the wall.

A chill washed over her, making her instantly regret not pulling a top on before Adora had led them away. After what felt like forever, Adora called down for Catra to come up and within minutes she had reached the top.
"WAIT! Can you please close your eyes?"
"Um Adora, I'm kind of hanging off the side of the tower right now."
"Oh, right, um hang on," Adora strode over, placing a hand around Catra's waist to hoist her up, "promise they're closed?"
"Pinkie swear it."

With that, the blonde effortlessly picked Catra up and led her over to… well Catra didn't know what because she *couldn't see.*.
"Okay on three, 1…2…3!"
Catra opened her eyes slowly, letting them adjust to the light, or lack thereof.
Seriously, when had it gotten so late?
When they did adjust however, a gasp escaped her.

The sun was setting over the Fright Zone casting pink and golden hues across everything; in front of her white blankets were spread

out on the floor, framed by roughly five grey pillows like the ones they had on their bunks; small round things were lit on fire, set up in a small huddle at the centre of blankets, their light flickering in the evening breeze.

Catras eyes grew as round as the three moons above them when she saw what was besides the glowing things. They were, what Catra thought, looked like the most un-Horde like food she'd ever laid her eyes on.

"Oh…"
"Do you like it?" the grin on the blonde's face showed just how proud she was. Catras eyes started welling up again.
Fuck Lonnie for making her feel so fucking fragile

"What's wrong? Do you… do you not like it?" Adora's face fell,
"No! No, its just so…" Catra was struggling to find the right words, instead choosing to flap with her hands at everything in front of her. "You did this for me?"

"Well Scorpia helped me get the food and Can-Dels" she pointed to the small glowing objects, saying the two syllables slowly to make sure she got it right, "but uh, yeah."
Adora gave an awkward smile, "She said it was called a Pick-Nick."

"Pick-nick…" the word felt nice on Catra's tongue, "But why did Scorpia help you with this? I was a complete asshole to her." She felt a twinge of guilt tug in the pit of her stomach.
Adora gave a small smile, "She said that she didn't blame you for it, that she knew you were just acting out of self-defence. I uh… I actually spoke to her a lot about you, whilst you were, y'know, passed out. She's a really good listener."
Catra tilted her head quizzically at Adora, waiting for the girl to carry on. She didn't, instead changing the subject;

"So anyways: Surprise!"
The massive grin reappeared on her face and Catra felt a slight tugging in her chest at the sight. Catra still didn't understand why Adora went to all this trouble for her:

"But why did you do all this for me?"
"Because, I want you to know that I care about you Catra. And, that I'll always be here for you." The smile on Adora's face was now paired with a dusting of pink on her cheeks.
"Now come on! I want to try some of this food Scorpia stole for us from contraband!"
"You know Shadow Weaver would kill us if she found out?"
A mischievous grin spread across the girl's face,
"Exactly."

Adora yanked Catra down with her onto the blankets, immediately reaching for one of the pink circles in front of them.
"Oh my god." Her pupils grew so big Catra though they might burst, "This is AMAZING!" She let out a moan of pleasure at the taste making Catra's eyes to go just as big,

"Fuck me"
"What?"

Catra clamped her jaw together, *did she really just say **that** out **loud?!!***

"N-nothing! Just can't wait to try this… uhh this… pink ration bar?"
"I think Scorpia called is a bisquit? Or was it biskite… whatever it is, it's fucking brilliant."
Catra choked a little at that, Adora literally **never** swore. Hearing it made her feel slightly proud if she was being honest. Proud, and turned on.

"That good huh? Guess I'll have to try one then."
Catra tentatively picked up a pink bis-something and nibbled down on it.
"Holy fuck Adora! Where on Etheria has the shit been our whole lives!" Adora snorted as Catra shoved another whole one into her mouth, crumbs covering her face.

"Oh, you have a little bit of…" Adora gestured to her face. "No no, it's right-" Catra licked around for mouth, "Hang on let me just…"
Adora leant over slowly, cupping Catra's jaw with her hand.

Gently, she ran her thumb over the corners of the girl's lip, glancing up slowly to a wide eyed Catra.

Their eyes locked together, Adora's thumb still resting on Catras chin. She stared at Adora mouth slightly open as she took a slow breath.
She didn't know if she could ever put into words what Adora made her feel.

Adora let out a soft gasp as she looked up, her breath tickling the brunette's cheek. "Catra, look!" She gently lifted the girls chin upwards, "The sky look so beautiful tonight…"
Catra wasn't sure what 'beautiful' meant (Adora had probably learnt it from Scorpia), but if it described the breath-taking view above them then Catra was sure there was no better word for the girl sitting beside her.

***

She didn't know how much time had passed, the temperature had dropped considerably low since sunset, resulting in the two girls snuggling close together as they lay looking up at the sky.
Adora was gently stroking Catra's hair as her tail wrapped around the blonde's leg.

"You make me really happy Catra."

Catra turned her head towards Adora, the girl's eyes still trained on the sky,

"You make me happy too.", a smile tugged on Adora's lips as she let out a long sigh.
"I feel like you complete me."

Catras breath hitched. She knew Adora was tired, she always got like this late at night. Sentimental. But it was different somehow.
A smell washed over Catra, delicate and soft, coming from Adora. She'd never smelt this one before, it was intoxicating.

<"You're my best friend Catra."
"And you're mine." She offered a coy smile to the girl but her eyes were still on the sky.
"Do you think there's something more than best friends?"

Catras head jolted so fast she was shocked it didn't snap.
"Like what?"
"Like… there's friends, and then there's best friends; do you think there's something after that?" A puff of smoke rose up from Adora's mouth.

Oh, right.

"I heard of this thing once, soulmates, in a book. Some trashy one I found in an older cadet's bunk when I was exploring a while back. It said that a soulmate is someone who you'll carry with you forever. That they're someone you're destined to meet, destined to be with."
A silence washed over them, each deep in their own thoughts.

"That's like a story Scorpia told me."

Stars, how much did those two talk?

"She called it the 'Red Strings of Fate'. Her mums would tell it to her when she was little, claimed it was how they met.
"She said that we all have a vein that runs from our hearts to our little finger,"
Adora held her hand above them, running one of her fingers from her chest up her arm to the tip of said finger,
"and from that extends a red thread. Everyone has a string connected to someone else's and the two people connected will have an important story, regardless of the time, place or circumstances.
Together they'll make history. "

The blonde moved her finger away from her pinkie, trailing it through the air,

"The red string might get tangled but it can never break. Those two people will be tied together forever - tied together by fate."

Adora lifted Catra's hand slowly, pulling it up so it was also in front of them. She watched silently as the blonde trailed her finger over to Catras.
"I think ours connect."
"You do?"

Catras voice was scarcely more than a whisper,
"Well, yeah. We both came into each other's lives and stuck together ever since, no matter what was thrown at us. I think that means we're meant to make history together." Adora sat up, her eyes meeting Catra's, "Don't you?"
"I… yeah, I hope so…" *because I don't ever want to live in a world without you.*

Adora grinned at her again,
"Close your eyes."
"Seriously Adora? I've done that like, five times since we've been up here!"
It might have been a slight exaggeration on her part but having her eyes shut made Catra feel vulnerable, she wasn't able to watch her back.

"Please? One last time? For me?" Adora looked down at her, a small pout on her lips. Catra thought she would do anything Adora asked her too if only she looked at her like that.
"Ugh fine." So Catra shut her eyes, seeing a soft smile dance across Adora's face.

A soft thump alerted Catra to Adora standing up, shots of anxiety beginning to flood through her.

What if Adora just left her here? What if she was going to get Shadow Weaver and this was all some elaborate plot to punish her?

Catra had to remind her that this was Adora, **her** Adora. The Adora who called people 'dumb face' just for upsetting Catra. She could trust Adora.
She took a deep breath just as she felt Adora drop on top of her stomach, straddling her legs either side of the brunette's torso.

This was a pretty normal position for the two of them (although Catra was usually the one on top of Adora) but something about this felt so much more… Maybe it was the fact Catras eyes were closed; or maybe it was the way Adora leant across her, reaching for Catra's hand.

"Adora, that tickles!" Catra squirmed under the blonde, her eyes still shut,
"I'm sorry, I'll be done in one minute I promise!" Catra continued to squirm causing Adora's legs to tighten around her to steady herself. "Stay still!"
"I can't! You're tickling me!" Adora let out an exasperated sigh before grabbing both of Catra's hands and pinning them beside her head.

Catras eyes shot open, landing on Adora whose face was much closer to her own than it was when she closed them.

"Now, stay still." Her voice was strong and low, warm breath ruffling Catra's eyelashes as Adora flexed her arms either side of Catra's head to get a better grip.
The brunettes mind short circuited;
Adora looked **really** hot.

Catra did her best to steady her heart beat, which was going at least triple what it was meant to, by averting her eyes away from Adora's face.
Big mistake.
Because then she was looking at the blondes toned shoulders tensing above her; and if she looked away from them, she saw the way Adora's legs straddled Catras hips as her ass pressed down against Catra's abdomen.

Every nerve in her body was on fire; from the place on her forehead where Adora's hair was grazing her skin, to the aching in her stomach from suppressing her heavy breathing. But what got to her most was the overwhelmingly intoxicating scent coming from Adora.
That sweet, delicate scent Catra wished she could drown herself in, mixed with a…sharper one that Catra felt she would know had her brain not been in overdrive.

"Okay, done!"

Catras snapped back from her spiralling thoughts of *Adora* to see a beaming one staring down at her.
"Look at your wrist!" Adora grabbed Catra's arm up causing a small yelp to escape her, "Oh my gosh, I'm so sorry! I forgot about the brusies…" A look of concern washed over her as she scanned Catras face. She could feel her skin heating up.
"It's fine, don't worry about…" Catras sentence was cut off by a soft gasp at the sight before her. Wrapped around Catras wrist was a black bracelet braided together with a single strip of red.

"Adora… I- I don't know what to say…"
"It's called a friendship bracelet! The red represents our string of fate tying us together. See how it gets all tangled up but ends in the same place? It shows how we'll always come back to each other, no matter what." Adora smiled at her again, clearly proud of her handiwork.
"It's a promise, from me to you"

Dork

"Adora it's…" Catra was at a loss for words, her heart so full for the dumbass blonde grinning down at her.
The girl lifted up her own hand up to reveal a white bracelet wrapped around her own wrist, also entwined with a red strip. "So we can always be with each other, even when we're apart."
Catra yanked Adora down on top of her, wrapping her arms, legs and tail around the girl, drawing a muted "oof!" from her.

“Thank you.”

Catra felt Adora smile into her neck and when they pulled back Catra was surprised to see a blush forming on the girl’s cheeks.
“I’m really glad you like it. I was super worried you would think they were stupid or something…”
Catra was taken aback by this, nothing Adora did for her would ever be in her eyes.

“C’mon, its really late. We should at least try to sneak back in when everyone’s asleep.”
Adora’s face fell a little at this, like she had forgotten they had somewhere to be. Catra was satisfied to see a trace of disappointment from the girl.

“Really though Adora, thank you.” She said it with her whole body, purring against the blonde's chest whilst wrapping the girl in another hug. She pulled back slightly looking into Adora’s eyes.

“What was that?”
“What?”
“You just blinked, like really slowly at me. You’ve done it before but I just thought you were tired.”

Fuck

“Oh uh… it’s a feline thing. It basically just means that uh… that I’m really grateful and- and happy right now…"

It was close enough to the truth

“Oh. Okay then,” Adora looked Catra in the eye and slowly blinked at her.
Catra could have sworn her heart would leap right out of her chest had it not been for a sudden gust of wind the swept across them. She shivered slightly.

“Do we need to bring this back?”
“Nope, Scorpia said she’d get one of the cleaning bots to get it in the morning, that way we won’t have a chance of getting caught.”

That goddamn Scorpia
Catra made a mental note to thank her for all of this someday. It was only fair after Catra's less than amiable first impression.
Adora rolled off of Catra's chest, the absence of heat hitting her like a ton of bricks.

"You're cold." Adora slipped her jacket off, wrapping it around Catra's shoulders. The thing hanging midway down her thighs. It had been a gift to Adora from Shadow Weaver for graduating top of their year (only beating Catra in agility because Lonnie and co. had teamed up against her). Adora had worn it almost every day since then, evident in it smelling so overwhelmingly of her.

Catra took a deep breath in.
Here standing in Adora's jacket on top of a tower surrounded by blankets, the three moons glowing above them, Catra could almost pretend they weren't in the Horde. That it was just the two of them, living their lives together, side by side every day.

As they wandered back, Catra wondered if that was possible. For two people to live side by side, every day, forever. If it was, Catra knew she wanted nothing more than to have it with Adora.

Chapter End Notes

Hey guys!! just some info for ya: slowing blinking in cats means 'i love you'
Love me some angsty Lonnie and soft gay lesbians.
Do you guys think Catra ever liked anyone other than Adora in the Horde? or if she even knew what she was feeling? personally i think she only ever had eyes for Adora but didn't really know what it or love was (I mean it is the Horde, they don't exactly teach you that sorta stuff)

Love you all and see you next week! <333
And thank you so much for reading

Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

hi guys, sorry if the layout is a bit muddled, its really late and i did my best to proof read <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV

Dear Diary,
I have been feeling really strange lately.
*Like yesterday in training – I had just taken down a bot and Rogelio (who **never** speaks) said 'nice one!' to me so obviously I was super proud of myself, it was like a pretty good take down! I slid under its legs and stabbed up through the centre and I'M GETTING DISTRACTED*

So, I was happy and then I saw Catra staring at me from the corner of my eye (she's been doing it a lot lately???). But when I looked over, she wasn't staring at me anymore?
*And the she did look at me, doing that half smirk she does where the right side of her lip angles up just enough for one of her fangs to poke out (I really like her fangs) and then she **winked** at me!*
Randomly after that, I started feeling short of breath and my face got hot.
I asked Scorpia (she has the spikey shoulders) what she thought it might be because I don't want to be sick, and Scorpia knows a lot about health and illnesses; but all she did was tell me that it's something I need to work out for myself and then she giggled to herself about it.
So unfair!
Because the thing is Diary, I have NO IDEA!!!

Ugh I wish there was some book that told me what it all meant… maybe I could ask Catra? She'd probably call me a dummy or something but she's really good at finding solutions; like when I

told her my feet got cold at night and she suggested she could sleep on them - Lonnie said I should just wear socks to bed but Catra insisted they wouldn't warm me up enough and that she's always super warm so it would work.
Speaking of Lonnie, said she has something to show us all later, I really hope it's not against the rules.
Shadow Weaver always blames Catra for the bad things, even when they aren't her fault...

I think I hear people coming back now so I gotta go,

TTYL (talk to you later),
Adora <3

P.S - That's another thing that's totally unfair. Catra ***always*** *gets blamed… :/*
P.P.S - Look how cute hearts are! <3
P.P.P.S - I reeeally like Catras fangs

Adora quickly snapped her diary shut, shoving it underneath her mattress to ensure nobody accidentally stumbling upon it (Shadow Weaver) – she wrote a lot of pretty embarrassing things on its pages that she most definitely didn't want the whole squad to know.

The notebook had been a present from Scorpia who said writing down thoughts made them less overwhelming, and it had seemed to be working in terms of stopping Adora's head get so filled up.

However, one thing it hadn't helped with was figuring out what all those things meant.
Especially like what happened in training yesterday.

It was always the same:
Adora would be proud of herself and instinctively seek out Catra, finding the girl giving her a smile or *something* and then, like clockwork, she would feel like her chest was squeezing together.

“Hey Adora.”

Crap, there’s that feeling again

“Catra! Hey, how was clean up duty?”
“Ugh, don’t even talk about it. I swear Shadow Weaver makes me do washing up solely because she knows how much I hate water!”

Catra carried on grumbling about how annoying Shadow Weaver was as Adora watched her softly. She was trying to listen to what the girl was saying but she kept getting distracted by the way Catras mismatched eyes seemed to glow in the low light of the bunks.

Catra’s hair had fell over her eyes slightly, tickling at her cheekbones.
The red headguard that so often framed the girl’s face wasn’t perched atop her head, instead lying discarded on the bed; Adora thought she looked softer without it, less like a solider and more like a teenager.

Soft Catra was one of Adora’s favourites. She was more affectionate, smiley and often more truthful.
It was on those nights that they would stay up until gone midnight, whispering secrets beneath the thin sheets, giggling so close they felt each other’s breath and falling asleep tangled in each other’s limbs.
It made Adora’s heart flutter just thinking about it, hearing Catra whisper her name…
Adora
Adora

“ADORA!” “Huh?!” The blonde was jolted out of her thoughts to a sharply clawed hand smacking in her forehead. “Catra! Ow!”
“Stars Adora, what were you thinking of that made you so oblivious to me calling your name that last one thousand times!”
Catra was laughing as she reached over, lacing her fingers into Adora’s, the bracelet she gave her still dangling around her wrist.

Catra had been a little off with Adora since getting the bracelet, more reserved, so the blonde was pleased she was being more physical again.
Adora had secretly been worried it was because of the bracelet, but since the girl hadn't removed it she decided it was probably up to stress for their upcoming exam.

"You know that if we don't hurry up the hot water will be cut off from the showers; and I **cannot** deal with another 10-minute speech about the injustice of it all from you."
Catra mock clutched at her heart with her free hand, feigning a sigh that got her a playful shove in the shoulder from the blonde.

"I'll have to meet you there Catra, Shadow Weaver said she wanted to have a 'talk' with me…"
The girls gave each other a knowing look. You never knew what you were getting yourself into with Shadow Weaver until you arrived.
"Oh, okay. Well don't be too long; you know how much I hate showering and it's even worse when I'm alone…"
Catra had a tone of disappointment in her voice which Adora could only pin down to the fact that she had to get herself wet later.

She let out a groan as she got hauled up off the bed by the other girl.
Catra was way stronger than anyone gave her credit for, all lean muscles without the bulkiness Adora had.
It was one of the reasons the girl had such an edge over Adora in speed and agility.
That, and being part feline.

Scorpia had called her a 'Magicat' awhile back, but Adora wasn't quite sure what it meant; and quite frankly? She was a little scared to ask…
*The word literally had 'Magic' in it and magic can **never** be good.*

The two of them parted ways, Catra trudging off to the showers grumbling about how long it will take for her hair to dry, and Adora in the direction of the black garnet chamber aka. Shadow Weavers quarters.
Adora hated that room, its dingy smell, the lack of light casting shapeshifting shadows across the room. But mostly she hated it because of the massive red stone in the centre, a menacing red glow constantly protruding from it.

A shiver ran up Adora's spine as she thought about all the times as kids her and Catra had snuck into the room… all the times they had been caught.
As soon as Shadow Weaver entered the room Catra would tense up, her tail hanging low in between her legs. Adora would instantly feel a surge of protectiveness coarse through her, instinctively stepping in front of the girl to shield her from Shadow Weaver.

Of course it was never enough.
Adora would always be pushed outside the room, shouting for Catra to be let go because 'It was my fault! Catra had nothing to do with it!"
But each time all she was met with was a sigh and "Now now Adora, you can't keep taking the fall for Catra or she'll never learn."

She would wait outside until a slightly trembling Catra with tearstained eyes came shuffling out, Shadow Weaver watching them from behind.
She would never tell Adora what happened when the door was closed, it was one of the things the Catra just didn't discuss. Adora was kind of thankful for it if she was being honest; she didn't know if she could deal with the knowledge of what she had let Catra go through.

Adora approached the large steel doors slowly, questioning whether to knock when they slid open.

“Adora,” Shadow Weavers voice was low, drawing out each vowel, “How are you my dear?”

“Fine Ma’am.”

“I expect you’ll be much more than ‘fine’ when you hear what I have to say.” A calm in her eyes told Adora this would be a so-called good chat.

She raised her head to meet the woman’s gaze.

“I’ve been doing some thinking and, if you perform as the ruthless soldier I’ve brought you up to be in your exam tomorrow, I have decided to make you a Force Captain.”

Adora’s mind short circuited, all efforts of thought dying in those words wake,
“F-force Captain Ma’am?”

“Why yes Adora, I believe the title would suit you quite expertly, don’t you think?”

“Well I- thank you Ma’am! I promise I won’t disappoint you tomorrow.”
“I should hope you, or I’ll be having a word with a certain Catra of yours about the punishments of distracting other squad mates…”

Her mouth suddenly felt very dry.
One of the reasons Adora pushed herself to be the best of their class was because if she didn’t Catra would be blamed.
Adora didn’t know why Shadow Weaver hated Catra so much,
perhaps it was due to her lack of drive within training
but either way, Adora hated being caught in the middle.

“Of course Ma’am, but Catra has never been a distraction to me.”
“Hmm, so you say. Alas, only time will tell… Now run along, I believe it is your shower night, is it not?”

“Oh, of course Ma’am, yes. And thank you Ma’am.”

Adora spun on her heel and walked out of the room, willing herself not to run. Cowardice was not seen favourably within the Horde.
As soon as the doors closed behind her, a long sigh escaped her:

Force Captain! She was going to be a Force Captain!

Adora couldn't wait to tell Catra as she sprinted in the direction of the showers.

Upon entering, Adora was immediately engulfed in a cloud of steam; the droplets clinging to her skin and hair. Just having the warmth surround her allowed some of the tension to seep out of her shoulders, their weight dropping down a bit.
Classic Catra, the girl couldn't stand the water being anything less than boiling herself, despite her constant teasing of Adora for it.

She plodded over to the changing area and placed her clothes next to Catra's, marvelling at how neat the other girls folded clothes were in comparison to her own which she had just chucked on the bench.
At that moment as soft voice swam across the room, making Adora feel dizzy trying to pin their whereabouts;

And I'd give up forever to touch you
'Cause I know that you feel me somehow

The voice was silky and melodious, flowing into her ears with such ease that Adora started over to the showers, thick clouds of steam rising over her, without a second thought.

You're the closest to heaven that I'll ever be
And I don't want to go home right now

Adora knew it was only her and Catra in the showers and yet, the emotion in the song struck something in Adora. She forgot all thoughts of rationality in regards to the singer, instead letting the words soak into her skin.

And all I can taste is this moment

Adora had never heard this song before (she'd barely heard any songs before) but something about the words resonated with her.

And all I can breathe is your life

Images of her and Catra snuggling in Adora's bed flashed through her mind, sheets tangled between their limbs in the soft night time light, Catras tail casually grazing her leg;

And sooner or later, it's over
I just don't wanna miss you tonight

Waking up the next morning only to be torn apart by the harsh white light glaring down at them,

And I don't want the world to see me
'Cause I don't think that they'd understand

The breathy laughter that surrounded them after pulling a prank on Kyle, each clutching at their stomachs for breath…

When everything's made to be broken
I just want you to know who I am

…Catra crying into Adora's chest after a nightmare,

I just want you to know who I am

Cradling the girls head against her.

I just want you to know who I am

Adora stepped into the showers quietly, her eyes fixing on Catra whose body faced away from her; it suddenly dawned on Adora that she was the one singing.

And you can't fight the tears that ain't coming

Her eyes were shut tight against the warm water as it washed over her face, words spilling over her lips;

Or the moment of truth in your lies

Adora's mouth hung open slightly at the sight. Catra looked… beautiful.
Her so often unruly hair was now slick against her back, beads of water gliding over her shoulders, running over her toned arms,

When everything feels like the movies
Yeah, you bleed just to know, you're alive

Catras voice cracked a little on the last line. She took a deep breath before continuing:

And I don't want the world to see me
'Cause I don't think that they'd understand

She bit at her lower lip, a sad smile playing against them as a careless laugh escaped her, lacing her voice in a strange sense of sorrow,

When everything's made to be broken
I just want you to know who I am

The brunette's hand ran through her thick hair, droplets cascading from the bottom

I just want you to know who I am
Adora watched as what seemed to be a tear run down the girl's face, though with all the water she couldn't be sure,

I just want you to know who I am

Catra never sang, especially not in front of people. And although Adora knew the girl didn't realise she was listening; she felt a pang of sorrow at it.
Her voice was so lovely…

I just want you to know who I am

Catra let out a sigh

I just want you to know who I am

The last line came out a mere whisper Adora was sure she would have missed had she not been standing so close.
She let out a breath she didn't know she had been holding,

"Fuck! Who the- Adora? I thought you were speaking with Shadow Weaver?"
Catra looked at her quizzically, the initial panic on her face receding

"You sing really good." Adora blurted it out before she could stop herself,

Wow Adora. 'You sing really good', is that honestly the best thing you could think of?

"Oh shit, you uh, you heard that?" Catra looked down sheepishly, water trailing off her nose

"I uh, yeah sorry I didn't tell you I was here. It was just…" Adora tried to find the right words, "What song was it?"
Catra mumbled something towards the floor that Adora didn't catch.

"Huh?"

"You uh- you wouldn't know it."
"I don't know, something about it seemed really… familiar?"

Catra looked up at her, her gaze a mixture of things Adora wished she knew the meaning behind,

"You really wouldn't know it Adora."
"C'mon Catra, just tell me who its by. The Crimson Wasters? I've heard some of their stuff before…"

Catra huffed, clearly in annoyance at Adora's persistence,
"You wouldn't know it because I- because I wrote it…" Catras gaze feel to the floor again, her feet shifting uncomfortably.

"You wrote it? Catra, it was amazing! How did you come up with it?"

"Um, thanks Adora but it's not amazing. It barely even makes sense…"

"No way! I thought it sounded incredible, you sounded incredible! What's it about? You were singing so… passionately and it sounded so raw; it must mean something to you, right?"

"No. No meaning behind. Just words; random words. That's all." Catra seemed anxious to change the subject so Adora let it slide. Still, she couldn't shake the feeling of familiarity in the words…

"Oh, okay."
Catra started towards the shower exit when she quickly spun around, a gleam in her eye:
"Oh, and I hope you don't think I'll be leaving the big towel for you by the way. That baby's all mine." Catra smirked as she turned away again, letting out a gasp when Adora grabbed her tail.

"Come on Catra! I'm way taller than you, it's only for if I get it!"
"No way, I finished first so I get dibs! You're just being a sore loser Adora." Catra dragged out the last syllable, letting it bounce of the high ceilings.
"But that's not fair, I had to see Shadow Weaver!"

"I don't care about that. You won't even admit I'm better than you in agility to her!"
Adora rolled her eyes at the memory of herself telling Shadow Weaver she could outmatch Catra in agility if she didn't have her enhanced abilities after geting called out on her lower marks – she also remembered how agitated it had made Catra, though Adora couldn't figure out why;

"Ugh, obviously you're better than me, but that's only because you run on all fours which is totally cheating!"
"Oh and grabbing my tail isn't?!" Adora snorted down at Catra

who looked up at her, arms crossed over her chest, trying with little success to surpass the smile breaking through her lips.
She looks so damn cute…
She shook her head at the thought, Catra would probably claw her eyes out if she ever called her it out loud.

Adora changed tactic, pushing out her bottom lip and making her eyes as big and round as possible before making eye contact with the smaller girl. The softening of Catra's ears told her it had worked.

"Ugh fine! You can have the stupid towel! But it's not because I like you, I'd just rather not see your bare ass in my face while I'm getting dressed."
"Oh you wouldn't? What's wrong with it? I thought you said I had a nice ass…" She did her best to smirk at Catra, seeing the girl's cheeks tinge pink before stalking off towards the changing area.
It was true, Catra had said she had a nice ass in training once. Adora hadn't thought much of it at the time, though the way Catras eyes had grown to the size of moons before she added 'for kicking' made Adora wonder whether she had actually meant to have said it out loud at all…

Now's not the time for this

"Y'know Adora, you're not even that much taller than me. I literally came up to your forehead until the start of the year when you suddenly decided to grow another fucking head." Catra called at her from the other side of the room.
"Yeah, yeah Catra, all I'm hearing is someone being jealous of my extra height." Adora grinned to herself walking towards the changing area as a huff filtered over to her.

"Whatever Adora, at the rate you're going, I'll be finished by the time you even start the shower."
Adora found that highly unlikely since almost half of their shower time was spent trying to get Catra's fur dry afterwards; something she was about to point out when her words died in her throat:

Catra wasn't wearing any clothes.

Obviously Catra wasn't wearing any clothes. They were showering for stars sake (something they did almost every other day) and yet the sight of her standing there, a towel that was much too short hanging from her hand, made any attempt at speaking futile for Adora.

She suddenly didn't know where to look, her eyes flicking all over the room, trying to avoid the unavoidable glances at Catra she couldn't stop.
The girl had clearly started working out more, for across her stomach lay the faint outline of abs, her shoulders sloping and rising ain all the right places, beads of water still clinging to her fur.
Adora's eyes darted over them, completely avoiding the region between the girl's stomach and collar bones.
Adora had seen Catra naked plenty of times and yet, the thought of looking at her now made the blonde feel a creeping of colour up her neck.

The girl's tail twitched tentatively behind her, "What?"
"Hm, what? Nothing. No-thing Ma'am" Adora cringed slightly at her choice of words, hoping the awkwardness of them would be ignored by Catra
Fat chance

"Adora, are you… are you blushing?"
"What! No, absolutely not. I-it's just hot in here with all the showers on and uh, stuff…"
"The showers aren't on Adora." Her eyes darted away from Catra, "Oh my stars, you are blushing! Adora, we've been showering together since before we could walk properly, does seeing me naked really come as such a shock to you?"

Would she please shut up about being her being naked!

"Wha- no, and I am not ***blushing!****" As if on cue, Adora felt her cheeks grow an even deeper shade of crimson.*

"Does seeing me naked make you feel embarrassed Adora?" Catra slowly walked towards her but she was frozen in place. A look of hunger laced the brunette's eyes,
"Come on Adora, look at me."

"Catra stop it."
"What? You said you weren't embarrassed, so what are you? Excited?"
Adora's eyes shot towards the floor as she gulped, running her forefingers over her thumbs,
"Does seeing me naked make you feel excited, Adora?"

Adora felt confused again, questions popping into her head at rapid fire:
What is happening? Is she excited? Why would she be excited? Crap, she's walking closer to me oh stars…
"Catra wha-? Why would it make me feel… feel excited...?"
Adora didn't want to admit it, but she silently prayed for Catra would give her a real answer because right now Adora was feeling something, and excited was the closest word to it she knew.
Catra froze in her tracks, her face twisting into a frame of horror at what she had just said.
"Nothing. I don't know why I said that. Forget it." The girl said nothing else as she hurried over to her clothes, tail slashing behind her.

Catra has a nice ass… Wait what?

Adora practically sprinted back to the showers, plunging herself beneath the water to try and wash away all the confusing thoughts in her head.
Surely it wasn't weird to think your best friend has a nice ass, right? Catra had told her she had a nice ass, even if she swore she meant for kicking…

Adora wondered if this is what an existential crisis felt like. She'd read the term once in a book from contraband that Catra had stolen.
Catra… Stars what did all of this mean

She tried slowing her breathing, counting back from 100 like Scorpia had taught her and feeling her heart start to go back to normal
She was okay, nothing was wrong with her; when the time was right she'd know what it all meant…

After a few more deep breaths Adora stepped out of the showers, leaving a trail of water behind her as she headed over to her clothes.
Catra was gone which Adora found weird. Her fur wouldn't be dry for at least another 10 minutes (and that was with the hand dryer on which Adora had definitely not heard)
Adora knew Catra putting her clothes on before she was dry would only make her sick from experience. And it was ***hard*** *to get Catra to admit she was sick; Adora had rather not have it happen all together at that rate.*

She quickly towelled off before heading back to the bunks, her hair slicked back over her head. When she entered, Lonnie saunter over:

"Uh Adora, would you mind fixing your girlfriend please? She's shivering in her bed because she didn't let her fur dry before dressing and just yelled at us when we told her to go back a dry it."
Lonnie jolted her head over to a quivering Kyle in Rogelio's lap who was running a hand up and down his back. His and Kyles friendship kind of reminded her of her own with Catra, she smiled at the image.
Hold up – 'Girlfriend?' What the hell was she on about?
"She's not my gir-"
"Yeah yeah, whatever Adora, just fix it okay? We have something fun planned tonight that doesn't include a sniffling Catra or Kyle."

Oh that's right, Lonnie had a surprise tonight…

Adora approached the bed cautiously, placing her feet heavily on the ground to alert Catra of her presence; the girl tended to lash out in these situations if people sprung themselves on her.

Something Adora had accumulated a number of scars for before realising.
"Hey Catra, it's me, Adora." She tried to make her voice light and cheery but the worry seeped through,

"Go away."
"Oh c'mon Catra, Lonnie said she had a surprise for us." Adora approached the ladder
"I don't care, do it without me."
"Well I care Catra. And I don't want you getting sick, it could bring the whole squad down…"
Adora knew Catra wouldn't accept any form of help right now unless it was for any reason other than to simply help Catra.

"Who cares. Let them get ill see what difference it makes to me."
Adora huffed a sigh, she was always so stubborn

"Look Catra, if you don't come out, I'm coming in." She stepped on the ladder to make her point clear, seeing a shivering lump buried beneath a blanket
Catra made no sound of response.
"Alright, you asked for it."

She wiggled herself underneath the covers coming face to face with the back of a very cold, very wet girl in half sodden clothing, sniffling against a pillow.
"Catra… why didn't you dry yourself first these are soaking! Come on, get them off." Adora tugged at the white t-shirt clinging to the poor girls wet fur, silently bringing it over her head as Catra lifted her arms up to help.

Adora didn't even think about the fact she was in bed with a half-naked Catra, instead totally focused getting the girl warm and dry,
"Good, these too."

Catra wiggled out of her shorts, shoving them off the bed with her feet.
"Okay you wait here, I'm gonna get you a towel and pair of my clothes"

The girl sniffed a grunt as Adora slid out from behind her, hurrying over to her drawer to grab a towel, the comfiest jumper she could find, a pair of drawstring grey shorts and a grey sports bra to match.
"Here you go, dry off with this a bit then put these on. Hopefully you haven't been wet for long enough to get a cold. When you're done come out so I can strip your sheets."

It was always like this, Adora looking after Catra, tending to her when no one else would go near her. She couldn't remember when it had first started but Adora always felt an immense sense of protectiveness over Catra.

After a few minutes a slightly less wet Catra clambered out of the bunk, hoodie pulled up over her head. She didn't utter a word, instead standing awkwardly to the side as Adora stripped the bed, tossing damp sheets into the dirty laundry pile and patting at the thin mattress.
Luckily it would be dry soon thanks to the material meaning she could put a new set of sheets on before morning.

"You can sleep in my bed tonight, can't have you catching a chill… for the squads' sake that is."
Catra nodded, twiddling her tail between her hands. Adora thought she couldn't have looked more adorable if she tried, swamped in her oversized hoodie and shorts.
She hated it when Catra was like this because it reminded her of just how fragile her best friend was – something many people often overlooked in Catra.

The girl had quite a few self-esteem issues that often presented themselves in her brash and harsh behaviour; however occasionally, they would cause her to completely shut down. And that was, in Adora's opinion, a whole lot worse.

She pulled the girl in for a hug, hearing Catra take a deep breath as she relaxed into the embrace, "You ready to go over to the others now?"
Catra gave a small nod before pulling back; her eyes were blood

shot, which Adora chose not to mention. She gave Adora a weak smile.

She reached down for Catra's hand and gave it a tight squeeze, running her thumb in circles along it. The girls tail instinctively wrapped around Adora's wrist.

As the two approached, Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio were sat in a triangle spinning something in the middle and giggling to one another.
"Hey guys! You joined us!" Kyle gave them a lopsided grin, his eyelids half shut. "Yay!"

"Uh yeah, what are you guys doing?"

"Lonnie stole an older cadet's alcohol so we're playing spin the bottle!" Kyle leaned into Rogelio's side, chuckling to himself.
He definitely can't handle his drink

The girl in question grinned up at them, obviously proud of herself,
"Yeah, I did! Don't worry though there's totally enough left for you guys to play with us." Lonnie was clearly less drunk than Kyle but she still tripped over enough words to sound sufficiently tipsy.

Adora sat down, pulling Catra with her. She still hadn't looked at Adora but their hands were still interlocked so Adora took it as a good sign.

"Adora it's your go! Spin the b-bottle!" Kyle hiccupped as he thrust the bottle of pungent liquid towards her.

"Okay…" Adora spun it half-heartedly, landing on Rogelio;
"Truth or dare?" the boy grunted,

Adora answered 'truth' to which Kyle squealed:

"Ooo brilliant! Rogelio does the best questions!" He gave the boy besides him a pat on the shoulder and Adora could have sworn it made his cheeks redden.

The game carried on, each taking the occasional drink when they didn't want to answer or when they just felt like having one. Catra went back to her normal self, though slightly less reserved (she had crawled into Adora's lap, purring happily as she had her tail played with)

Adora felt her earlier troubles slip away.

It was Adora's turn to spin the bottle again. She had been successful in avoiding it landing on Lonnie the entire night so it should've come as no surprise when the neck slowed to stop on the girl who instantly gave her a wicked grin.

"Truth or dare, Adora?"
She didn't know if it was to wipe the stupid grin off Lonnie's face or the alcohol talking but her lips formed the word "Dare,"

"I dare you to kiss me." Lonnie stared at her with an intensity of fire, a smirk spreading over her lips.
Adora felt Catra tense up in her lap, her purring coming to an abrupt stop as sharp intake of breath came from Kyle and Rogelio, the blonde boys mouth hanging open slightly.
Adora's mouth went dry.

"I- what? I'm not kissing you Lonnie!"
"Awh why not? You a chicken?" Lonnie imitated wings, flapping her arms about drawing a giggle from Kyle.

An irrational surge of anger swelled in the pit of her stomach; ***nobody*** *called Adora a coward.*

That was the only reason she then proceeded to lean across the circle, eyes locked on Lonnie's sending pure hatred her way, and slowly pressed their lips together.

It came as an even bigger shock to herself when Lonnie cupped her jaw with her hand to deepen it.
Adora felt another surge of anger wash over her.

Lonnie was a really good kisser.
Her lips knew exactly what they were doing, she even swiped her tongue across Adora's lip once or twice. The blonde's head felt dizzy as her eyes fluttered shut;
She only pulled away when Lonnie nipped at her lower lip, drawing a metallic taste into her mouth.

"Huh, you're not as shit of a kisser as I expected blondie." Lonnie winked at her; a smirk still spread across her face.

The boys snapped out of their shock quickly, taking turns again to spin the bottle whilst laughing to each other, but Adora was to unnerved to focus.

She had just kissed Lonnie. And even worse, she had ***liked*** *it.*
What the fuck.

Adora just about registered Kyle tell Catra it was her go and the brunette telling him to 'Go fuck yourself.' before storming out of the room.
"Where's she going? It;s past curfew, if Shadow Weaver catches her out she'll be dead."

"Beats me, said something about not wanting to 'play this stupid game' anymore." Lonnie let out a low laugh.

"For fucks sake Lonnie. None of that would have happened if you hadn't dared me to kiss you!"

"Ooo hoo, mighty big words for you aren't they Adora? Besides blondie, you could've drunk. You chose to kiss me, remember?"

Adora huffed as she stood up, shooting Lonnie a death glare.
"Oh shut up Lonnie. You called me a chicken, obviously I couldn't

back down from that."

"Ah well, now you've made the bitch sad again. Wonder what you'll do to cheer her up this time. Make her another bracelet perhaps?" Lonnie broke out into another dry laugh, cut off by a sharp punch to her nose.

"What the fuck?! Why the hell did you do that?" Lonnie's eyes brimmed with tears

"Never call Catra a bitch again or next time, I'll give you more than just a bloody nose."

A quiet fell over the room as Adora strode to the door. Lonnie made to retort but Adora had left before she could hear what it was. It didn't matter to her. Catra was all that mattered to her.

"Fucks sake Catra, where are you?" Adora whispered it to herself, not expecting a reply which was probably why she threw a punch towards the direction of the voice who replied

"So the princess swears now. Funny, I thought you were above that." Catra dodged to the side before sliding to the floor.

"Catra, there you are! Come on let's get back before someone finds us out of bed."
"Fuck you Adora."

"What?" she dropped down opposite the girl, legs extended out in front of her,

"Fuck you for always managing to make me feel like shit."
"Catra what are you-"

"Did you enjoy it?" Catras voice was dangerously low, "Having her pressed against your lips like that?"

"Having her- what Lonnie? Catra, I didn't what to kiss Lonnie; it was a dare!"

Catra snorted, "Seemed pretty happy when you moaned into her mouth…"
She had not been aware she had done that.
Catras eyes flitted down to Adora's bottom lips, "did she do that?"

"What?" Adora brushed a thumb over it, a smudge of scarlet appearing,
"Oh uh, yeah. But it's nothing Catra, honestly its fine."

"I see how you look at me Adora," Catra was very close to her now, straddling across Adora's lap, "the way your eyes glance down towards my lips when we're close… Tell me, if Lonnie had dared you to kiss me, would you?"

Adora gulped, her chest only inches away from Catras;
"Catra, what are yo-"

"What if I had dared you to kiss me. Would you?"

Adora's heart rate picked up, her eyes unable to leave the other girls face. She could smell Catras breath, feel it on her skin; a mixture of alcohol and something else, something sour.
Adora felt like they were dangerously close to crossing something neither of them quite knew the full extent to…

"Kiss me Adora." The girl leant in closer, their noses practically touching and grabbed Adora's wrists.

"What? Catra stop it, you're drunk."
"Kiss me like you kissed her."

The girls locked eyes, shaky breaths catching in their throats.
Adora heard something shout in her head 'Just go back to the bunks and you can forget any of this ever happened!'
But she felt something much stronger urging her to 'Stay, see what happens.'

Catras eyes glinted in the dull light, hungry and alive.
Adora watched her, the way her tail flicked through the air, thrashing wildly with impatience; the way her ears twitched, waiting for Adora to answer her pleas; the way she bit her lower lip, pink tongue dragging over them.

"Catra i-"
"Forget it Adora. It was stupid, of course you don't want to kiss me. We're friends, that's all and you'll never want anything other than tha-"

Catras voice was cut off by the crashing together of lips, Adora's hand wrapping into the brunettes long wild hair, the other gripping her waist.
Catra let out a gasp as she pulled back,

"Adora… what are yo-"
"What does it look like Catra? Now shut up and kiss me."

That was all the confirmation the other girl needed; leaning in eagerly, hands trailing through Adora's hair.

It was messy and furious, pent up feelings pouring into each other's mouths as hands grasped and clawed all over.
Catra tasted like autumn and smoke, alcohol and salvation.
Adora thought she could live forever and never taste something so sweet.

Every nerve in her body begged for her to touch every inch of the other girls:

The dip in her torso as her waist curved into her hips, the way she rocked slowly back and forth over Adora pelvis, legs tense at the movement. The way her claws grazed down the back of Adora's shoulders, nearly piercing the skin but never going all the way…

This was what the feelings had been. This had been what she was waiting for. The tightening of her chest, the catching of her breath. All along it had been Catra. Not some illness or stupid

anxiety;
Catra.

And Catra felt ***right.***

Her lips trailing along Adora's jaw, dropping to her neck; licking sucking and biting every inch she could reach. For someone of such high physical fitness Adora seemed to be losing her breath faster than she could imagine, panting as she curled her fingers in Catras hair.

"Adora," Catra let out a gasp, "you have no idea how long I've wanted to do this…"
Her voice was breathy and deep, a low growl escaping her lips when Adora's grip tightened in her hair.

That. *She wanted to hear more of* ***that.***

Adora unthreaded her hands from the girl's hair, raking them down her body until she reached the base of her jumper, tugging up at it.

"Off. Take this off." Adora's tone was strong and demanding, to which Catra obliged readily, slipping out of it like a gymnast.

Adora's breath hitched in her throat as Catra stared at her, drunken eyes swirling with desire.

"Touch me Adora. Make me yours." Her voice was sultry and breathless and Adora wanted nothing more than to do just that.

She traced her lips along Catras sharp jaw, hands pushing her hips down onto her.
"You're mine Catra. Mine." Maybe it was the alcohol talking but Adora felt no words could ever feel so right. She rocked Catra down against herself.
Mine.

"I'm yours. I only want to be yours." Catra purred into her ear, nuzzling at her lobe.

A wave of want crashed over Adora, spurring her into a frenzy of desire. She lowered her lips to Catra's once more before freezing;

What the stars was she doing?! Shadow Weaver would kill Catra if she found them… if she hadn't already seen them…

"Adora..?"

The blonde pulled back; eyes full of terror as they darted around them;
Shadows. There were so many shadows.

The hairs on the back of her neck stood up as a growing realisation of what they were doing, what she was feeling, hit her.

She can't kiss Catra. They were best friends; they couldn't do this.

She looked at Catra in horror, fear welling up inside her,
"Adora what's going on? Why did you stop?"
"She can see us…" it came out as a whisper but she knew Catra would hear it.
"Who can see us? Adora there's nobody here."

"Get off of me."
"Adora, what's going on?"

"GET OFF OF ME GODDAMMIT!" She hadn't meant to shout, the change in mood clearly startling Catra as the girl leapt off of her;

"Adora what are yo-" Her eyes narrowed suddenly, thin as slits,
"Oh, I see. You won't be Shadow Weavers little golden girl if you're caught with me, huh? Stars Adora, maybe Lonnie was right…"

Adora didn't care what Lonnie had said, she had to get away from Catra. She couldn't let Shadow Weaver see them together, the things she would do to Catra…

Adora stumbled away from her, she was sobering up now which meant the arrival of a throbbing in her head.

Fuck shit fuck shit fuck shit fuck shit FUCK

Why had she kissed Catra? Why didn't she listen to that stupid voice telling her to leave? Adora couldn't, wouldn't let herself like Catra, not like that. It would only cause the girl a world of pain that Adora didn't want to put her through.

It's fine, I'll wake up tomorrow and it will all be a bad dream… Why did she do this!!

She tumbled through the door of the bunks, the only sound she was met with being the low rumble of snores.

At least she wouldn't have to face them right now

Adora clambered into her bed, hands trembling as she pulled the covers over her head, unaware of all the time spent staring at the bottom of Catras bunk before falling asleep.

She had to forget it, ignore it

Adora didn't hear Catra re-enter the room.

Chapter End Notes

My my, how the tables have turned...
I'm coming to a close of this story now, only a couple more chapters left.

i should warn you all that the ending is bitter sweet, setting up for the start of the series (if that gives you any hints of what may happen next...)

Until then i hope you enjoyed the roller coaster of emotions in this bad boy!

I may not be able to update as regularly for the next few weeks as my exams are starting but i'll try my best!

Thank you all for reading, you make my heart so full <3

The End of the Beginning

Chapter Notes

> There is mention of accidental self inflicted injury, blood and abuse in this scene so please only read if that is okay for you!!
>
> Thank you all for reading <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV

"FUCK YOU ADORA! FUCK YOU!"
Catras voice echoed off the walls that the blonde had long since ran the corner of; if any barracks had been nearby, she was definite she wouldn't get to see the light of day tomorrow. Sadly, only the training rooms and showers were nearby.

Tears stung at her eyes which only made her seethe with more anger.
How could Adora always do this?! How was she always able to make Catra feel so worthless?
She felt sick as the anger coiled through her stomach, up her throat and suffocated her chest. Another, duller ache, also came from there, one Catra didn't want to face right now.

Adora had left her. For Shadow Weaver. Again.
And yet, she was still shocked. Every. Single. Time.

Maybe it was the promises made each time, the soothing words and comforting smiles that made her believe Adora really would choose her next time…
Each time 'next time' came around however, that belief got shattered and rebuilt from the rubble.

"How could you Adora…" Catra was still speaking out loud, perhaps in hopes the blonde might be lurking or that by putting

her anger out into the world it would somehow find the girl. Catra wasn't sure which was more pathetic.

"How could you make me so fucking hopeful just to throw it back in my face?"

Her eyes trailed down to the bracelet dangling around her wrist; a single red strand weaving its way through the darkness.
Promise my ass.

Catra unsheathed her claws as she pulled her hand back, ready to slash at the stupid string of promises.
Her vision was blurred with tears, her fingers were trembling. She so badly wanted to rip it to shreds and scatter it all over Adora's bed as the girl watched, just to show her how little she cared…
Or tried to not care.

Her heart was beating between her ears, her breaths were shallow and quick. The tears pricking at her eyes finally broke, tearing down her face. Catra's thoughts were fuzzy, her head throbbed and her throat grew tighter.
Her hand came down hard and fast, slicing with full force.
Red trailed to the floor.

"Fuck. Fuck Fuck Fuck FUCK!" She'd missed the bracelet, instead slashing a huge gash in the side of her forearm and it stung like shit.
Not only that but it was deep and rapidly losing blood.
Fuck her burry eyes.

No. Fuck Adora for making her eyes so blurry that she couldn't even see through them.

Catra tried to convince herself that was the only reason she had missed, burying the juxtaposing thoughts creeping in deep down.
Her legs gleamed with blood, the metallic scent infiltrating her nose.
Bleeding is bad. Stop by clotting through pressure.
She thanked her lucky stars she wasn't too drunk and hadn't lost

too much blood to be able to form a coherent thought as she ripped of Adora's jumper.
She bound up her arm, avoiding thoughts of the blonde who'd given it to her.
Her work was sloppy and lumpy, but it would do the job. Even if the Horde sucked at health Ed classes, the survival skills weren't half bad.
If cut appears in limbs, elevate above the heart to decrease blood flow.
Catra staggered to her feet, her head suddenly feeling as heavy as lead. She doubled over in pain, eyes swimming with tears. *She would **not** pass out here.*
She thrust her arm over her head and used the other for support as she stumbled along the corridor, her vision darkening. She fell into auto pilot, trundling through the identical corridors towards a room she recognised painfully well.
Catra knew subconsciously that her cut was bad and it would definitely need medical attention. *Fuck the Horde for stashing stuff away in the medic room.*

She arrived at the door and slashed a square big enough to squeeze through. She could worry about the damage tomorrow. Maybe.
Catra knocked into a dozen trays laid out on the worktop, blood beginning to seep through the jumper on her arm.

Disinfect the wound thoroughly to decrease risk of infection
Catra wanted to slap herself for not paying attention to which ones to use, but instead she thrashed blindly through the cupboards looking for some sort of bottle with the word's 'disinfectant' on.
She grasped at a bottle that said 'hydrogen peroxide' in thick black letters with a picture of someone dripping it on themselves in a red triangle.
That meant she could put it on her skin, right?
No scent left the bottle when she uncapped it, something Catra decided to take as a good sign. Her earlier coherent thoughts seemed to be rapidly deteriorating.

She clawed through the sodden bloody material around her arm and discarded it to the floor and without a second thought she doused her cut in the clear liquid.

The bottle crashed to the floor, shattering across her feet leaving even more cuts. The brunette shrieked in pain, her skin and fur practically dissolving before her eyes everywhere the liquid had touched her.
Blood poured out of the wound, thick and warm, coating everything in its wake in crimson. Her mind was slowly becoming more and more foggy.
So this was how she was gonna die. A writhing pile, bleeding out onto the floor.

She knew she'd lost way too much blood to live when she began manically laughing to herself;
"Looks like…red triangles…mean…danger...!" She doubled over, heaving. The smell of acidic bile stinging at her eyes.
The world went dark as she fell to the floor, exhausted.

***
Black, empty, endless.
Giggling kids, footsteps running through hallways, two words.
"I promise."

***

Red, peppermint, warmth.
Whispered pleas, soft material encasing her arm, a wavering voice.
"Come on, keep it together. You can do this, come back to me…"

***

Blue, barren, metallic.
A gentle shove, a glowing rimmed door, a single word.

“Go.”

***

Catra’s eyes fluttered open to blinding white light. Pain seared through her eyes and her entire body felt like lead.

A loud groan escaped her as she tried shifting her body,
“Whoa Wildcat, don’t move too quickly. You’re seriously not in a good state.”

Wild…cat?

Her eyes settled on a large red and white blob looming over her;
“Who…” Speaking felt like she was eating sandpaper, with her mouth so dry she could taste it.

“Don’t worry Wildcat, it’s just me. Do you remember my name?” Catra’s eyes focused on the person in front of her: their hair was as white as the powdered milk in the cafeteria with a red face guard resting just below their eyes; a warm smile spread across their face with the softest eyes Catra had ever seen to match.

“Sc-scorpia?” She choked out the words,
“That’s right Wildcat, Scorpia. Gave me quite a fright finding you passed out on the medical room floor covered in blood. Half thought someone had attacked you before I reminded myself this was *Catra* I was looking at! Ha! Ain’t nobody attacking you without getting ripped to shreds, eh Wildcat?”

“What are you…” Her voice trailed off, her eyelids feeling awfully heavy all of a sudden.

“Nu-uh missy; we are not falling asleep right now.” She pressed a small bit of ration bar to Catra’s lips which she bit at tentatively,
“You haven’t eaten or drank anything in two days.”

That caught her attention;
"Two days?!" She bolted upright, instantly regretting the decision when a wave of nausea hit.
"Hey whoa! Slow down. No sudden movements until we've gotten some grub in you okay."
Scorpia brought a cup of water up to her, "Come on, drink up."

"What the- No! Get off me! I- I missed my exam! She'll kill me. Holy fuck she's gonna kill me…" Catra's mind went into overdrive, images of all the different ways Shadow Weaver would discard of her cluttering up every space possible.

"Wildcat it's okay, an announcement came out yesterday saying all training Cadet exams were getting rescheduled to later today. You've got nothing to worry about, okay?"
Catra tried to still her hands from shaking, threading them through her tail.
Two days. She had still been out for two days. The amount of training she'd have missed… had her squad wondered where she was? She doubted it, Catra was always going missing but two days? That was along time to go missing for...
It was only through these thoughts that Catra noticed her arm didn't hurt at all.

She glanced down to see a clean, neat bandaged was wrapped around her forearm; a small heart drawn on the part by her wrist, just above the stupid bracelet.
"I see Adora made you the bracelet! Oh it looks lovely, she really out did herself! Oh and um, sorry about that heart. When I get nervous, I tend to draw and well, you weren't breathing and I thought you maybe you were dead and-"

"You did this?" Catra didn't know why her voice was so cold. She should've been grateful to Scorpia for looking after her (again) yet for some reason she felt… violated. Like Scorpia had seen her when she wasn't meant to,
"Why did you do this?"

“Why did I-? Wildcat, you were lying in a pool of your own blood and vomit when I found you. Why would I just leave you there?”
The girl looked taken aback, like the mere thought of not helping Catra was unfathomable.
“You hate me. I was horrible to you; you should have left me to die.”
“Wildcat! Don’t say those sorts of things! Of course I wasn’t going to let you die. Besides, I don’t hate you, I barely even know you.”

“SO WHY DID YOU DO ALL THOSE THINGS FOR ADORA AND ME?!!”

The shouting rubbed her throat raw, leaving her open mouthed and gasping afterwards. She hadn’t realised she had been so worked up about that until now.
Although, it suddenly made sense as to why she always felt guarded when Scorpia was mentioned.
“You don’t know me, know us! So why did you do it?” Her words were filled with venom, rage seething through her teeth.

“B-because I like you guys! And Adora was, well, she was really worried about you and had a lot going on I- I thought it would be nice…” Scorpia looked away, her eyes downcast. The former smile on her face was replaced by a trembling lower lip.

Catra knew she should’ve felt bad, or should’ve at least apologised to the girl. She didn’t.
Instead she snatched the ration bad from the bed (she wouldn’t make that mistake again) and stormed out of the room, right back to the Bunks.

On her way back, she fantasised over what might happen when she re-entered:
Would everyone cheer and applaud as she came back in? Run over to her and ask what had happened? Would Adora run up to her and say she never meant any of it, Shadow Weaver be damned, and kiss her in front of the entire squad?

Catra knew it was stupid, that they would all be mad at her for missing training, but she couldn't help but let her mind wander. A constant thought that kept popping up was what if Scorpia hadn't found her… What would have happened to her.

A chill ran along her spine as she remebed the feelings before she had awoken in Scorpias bed, the single word *"Go."* replaying in her mind.
Maybe she *had* died…

Catra shut off that part of her mind just as she reached the bunks door. She wiped away the crumbs from her face, took a deep breath, and walked in.
"Catra! There you are, we've been looking everywhere for you!"

Those words never reached her ears, instead being welcomed by her squad shuffling into their gear.
"Catra, thank fucks your back. Shadow Weaver wants to speak with you before the exam so you better change quick or we'll all be late." It was Lonnie, but her voice didn't have its usual resentment towards her in it.
Kyle waved before toppling over with loss of balance, cargo pants down round his ankles. Rogelio gave him his hand after tipping his head to Catra in greeting.

Why was everyone acting so weird?
It was as if they'd all forgotten how to act around her, especially Lonnie and Kyle. Ever since her last 'meet up' with Lonnie had ended so badly, the girl had tried her best to always give Catra evil stares. But just then she had looked at her as if none of that had ever happened, as if they had never happened…

The thought flew from her mind when she spotted an oh so familiar blonde hair poof over by their bunks, she stopped in her tracks

Crap, Adora must've told them all what happened and they all felt so bad for her they were actually being… nice?
Catra felt a twinge of anger, she hated pity.

She took another deep breath before continuing over to the bunks.
"Uh, hey Adora."
The blonde spun around, shocked at the sudden presence behind her,
Here it come, the yelling and fighting…

"Catra!" The girl flew towards her, making Catra tense up.
Great, she was gonna get punched in the face
Catra braced herself for the impact but it never came, instead she was wrapped in a warm hug, paired with a muffled "Where were you?"

What the fuck?
"What do you mean where was I? You left me in the middle of a pitch black corridor after we-"
"Left you? Catra, I haven't seen you all morning! I fell asleep to you lying on the foot of my bunk and haven't seen you since!"

Catra looked at her, perplexed. Could it honestly be that she remembered nothing from two nights ago? Sure Adora had been slightly drunk but she hadn't had *that* much, right?
And besides, Catra had been missing for two days. She definitely hadn't fallen asleep at the foot of Adora's bunk last night. Unless Scorpia had been lying to her, but for some reason she didn't deem that likely.

"Oh Catra! What happened to your arm? Is it okay?" Adora reached out to touch it but Catra yanked her arm away, "Oh I'm so sorry! Is it still sore?"

Why was she acting like everything was fine? Catra couldn't comprehend it all. *First Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio; and now Adora? Why was everyone acting so normal?!*

"You should hurry up and get dressed! Shadow Weaver said she wanted to speak with you before the exam!" Adora was a bundle of energy, springing on the balls of her feet.

Catra managed to find her voice ,
"Why did she push back the date?"

Adora looked at her perplexed, "What do you mean pushed back? Shadow Weaver hasn't changed the date, has she?" Adora looked over at the rest of the squad, "Oi guys, Shadow Weaver hasn't changed the exam date, has she?"

"Uh no? What makes you think that?" Lonnie called back,
"Nothing, don't worry about it." Lonnie gave them a sceptical look before she resumed putting her kit on with meticulous precision. Sloppiness wasn't allowed in the Horde. Especially not in exams.

"Wonder why you thought it was changed." Adora gave her a quick shrug before following Lonnie in putting on her kit, "Catra, why aren't you getting ready? We only have half an hour!"

Adora flung some clothes at the girl who stood there in a trance.

It didn't make sense. Scorpia had said an announcement went out, and besides she ***had*** *been knocked out for at least one night, so Adora saying she slept on her bunk last night was impossible… And yet the blonde had seemed dead serious when saying so.*
Similar thoughts crowded her mind as she started throwing on her gear, taking little care in their presentation.
As soon as she was dressed Adora grabbed her non bandaged arm, leading her out of the room.

The two walked in silence for a while, Catra too confused and angry to peak, Adora too preoccupied with pre-exam jitters.
"So, what did happen to your arm?"

Catra didn't think delving into the whole story was worth it instead she replied simply by saying, "Cut myself by accident."

"But you've never accidentally cut yourself." Catra huffed a shrug at the girl, signifying her lack of enthusiasm for the conversation. Besides it was true, even if Catra didn't tell Adora she had been the reason.
"Ooo Catra, you're wearing a bracelet! Where'd you get it?" Adora

snatched at her hand, marvelling at the string hanging around it. All the air inside her lungs got knocked out of her.
Where did she get it? Where did she-

"Oh wow, it's so cool! I love the red bit in it!" The blonde looked at her with genuine enthusiasm. The snake of anger awoke from its slumber, coiling tightly around Catra's throat.
"Adora what the fuck? What do you mean 'where'd you get it?'" She said the quote in a mocking tone, Adora stared at her, puzzled.
"What? You didn't have it on yesterday so I assumed you got it from somewhere." The girl's tone was still obliviously cheery.

Obviously Adora just wanted to play with Catra. Make fun of her, work her up just before their exam so she'd fail!

"You absolute bi-"
"Girls! Welcome." Catra hadn't realised they were outside of Shadow Weavers room until the woman stood, looming above them.

"Hello ma'am." Adora's voice was robotic, the same way it always was when speaking with Shadow Weaver. Catra's however, was not.
"What do you want?"

"Now, now Catra. That isn't how we speak to our superiors, is it?" Her eyes had a wicked glint to them, "Adora darling, why don't you run on back to your squad? I assure you Catra will return to you all in time for the exam. Perhaps she'll have a better attitude then…"
The sentence was daring, baiting Catra to use her voice. However before she could, Adora replied with a curt nod, a squeeze of Catras hand and was gone.

"You. Get inside. Now." The honeyed tone used with Adora was replaced with a cold and harsh one as Catra stepped over the threshold. Every memory from inside this room flooded into her mind.

She swore there had to be some kind of magic put on the room to make you relive them upon entering…

"What a bad little girl you've been Catra." The doors slammed shut behind her, causing her to let out a yelp as a bit of her tail almost got caught.
"And squealing like a little pig, I see." Catra didn't know what a pig was, but she doubted it was any good. She felt her legs begin to buckle beneath her, using all her willpower to force them to stand up straight.

"Why am I here?"
"Oh dear, and I thought we had just talked about this." Shadow Weaver advanced towards her, "I suppose the animal needs some taming."

Red blurred across her sight, penetrating deep into the depths of her mind. Slowly, her feet lifted off the ground.
Pain writhed through her bones, the feeling of being ripped apart and sucked inward stabbed at her simultaneously.

"Why don't why try that again Catra? Ask me nicely this time."

Catra squirmed, trying to get out of the suffocating body bag encasing her which only sent stronger pulses of pain through her. She bit down to stop a cry from escaping her lips.
The taste of metal seeped onto her tongue.

"Don't be a thrashing animal, Catra. You and I both know it only makes it worse." Catra imagined she was sneering behind her mask as another jolt of energy surged through her.

"Do you have any idea what happened during the exam after you forced yourself onto my sweet precious Adora? She was distraught! Could barely think straight! She scarcely managed to disable even one bot before I stopped it!" Shadow Weaver spat in her face.

Something about the sentence didn't make sense, but she was in too much agony to figure out what.

“Don’t look so shocked, you insolent child! You knew exactly what you were doing, shoving your careless tongue down her throat!” Catra made a noise of protest at being told she initiated it, “And don’t you dare try and say it was my sweet Adora’s choice. She was confused and you, you greedy little bitch, you took advantage of that.” Shadow Weavers voice dropped low, her lips right beside Catra’s ear.

Catra let out a howl as Shadow Weaver strengthened the hold on her. “P-please, stop it… PLEASE!”
“Look at you, so weak you can’t even take your punishment without crying. It’s truly pathetic.” Without warning Catra crumpled to the floor, her whole-body twitching beneath her.
“The exam… you said the exam happened…” Catra didn’t know why that mattered to her, but it was all she could get out.

“Well of course it happened. What you thought just because you were missing, we would reschedule?” She let out a humourless laugh, “No one cared that you weren’t there Catra. Not one person.”
Shadow Weaver let her words wash over Catra, revelling in how the girl winced at the last part.

“A-adora said she d-didn’t know it was rescheduled, n-none of them knew…”
“Of course none of them knew. I won’t allow them to know.”
“W-what?” Catra’s words kept getting stuck in her throat. She hated how needy she sounded, begging Shadow Weaver for answers.
“You’ve only tasted a crumb of what my powers are capable of you brat. None of them shall know the embarrassment you became that night, none of them will know.”

Suddenly it hit Catra why everyone was acting like they didn’t remember,
“You wiped their memories.” She said it in disbelief.
Shadow Weaver was terrible, Catra couldn’t imagine anyone worse, but taking their memories? That was beyond anything Catra had thought possible.

“Indeed Catra.” She said it so casually, so calmly “And you will not utter a word of it to anyone. Especially Adora.”

All Catra could do was stare at the woman in horror.
“You **will** obey me, child. Do I make myself clear?” Red swarmed her vision again.
“Y-yes.”
“Yes what?”
“Yes, y-you make yourself… clear.” Catra struggled to get the last word out, finding herself gasping for air.
Shadow Weaver huffed, “Good. I suppose that means you won’t be needing *this* anymore.”

The bracelet around her wrist disintegrated, leaving a thin hairless band in its place. Catra willed herself to stay silent.
“As for this,” Shadow Weaver waved her hand and the bandage on her wrist disappeared along with the jagged gash beneath it, “I wish I could let you endure the pain you foolishly inflicted on yourself but for the sake of Adora, I cannot”

“H-how could you…”
“I’m sorry?”
“How could you… do that?”

“Do you dare question my authority Catra Applesauce Meow Meow? Why you little-“ Catras vision went black momentarily, “Alas I promised my darling Adora your return… Leave. And I will know if you speak a word of this to anyone.”

She collapsed to the floor, heaving to catch her breath.
“I said get out.”
Catra stumbled out of the room, heading towards the training facility. The dull ache of energy settling in her bones. Catra had the unsettling thought Shadow Weaver had made usre she could never tell Adora as long as she lived.

***

The squad had already begun the exam when she arrived. Forcing her hands to stop shaking she climbed up one of the posts and waited. They all looked so carefree that Catra wondered if things were maybe better this way…

No. What Shadow Weaver did was wrong.
There was no time for these thoughts as she watched a bot advance on Adora
Catra launched herself down towards it, Claws unsheathed. The taint of Blood on them slightly throwing her off for a moment. She landed with a soft thumb, just in time to kick the remaining leg into a deep pit.

Carefully, she tiptoed her way over to another pit. She took a deep breath.
Here goes nothing
"Hey Adora…"

Chapter End Notes

There we are everyone, I've officially finished my first fic!! <3 I'm sorry for the slightly sad and maybe rushed ending but i wanted to get this chapter out before my Exam weeks for you all!

Thank all so much for reading this, i couldnt have ever imagined all the support and love i was going to get from you all so thank you so, so much!!
Be sure to keep an eye on my page for new upcoming fics, and i may end up adding to this to a series in which i put oneshots in whihc the two see eachother throughput the show (The promise etc)

Once again thank you all so much, i love you all !!! <3 :D xxx

End Notes

hi guys ! This is my first time ever writing pretty much anything, so tips are welcome in the comments :))
im not sure how many chapters i plan on making this anywayssss hope you guys like it!! <<<3

i rated mature bc idk where this is going to go :o

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!